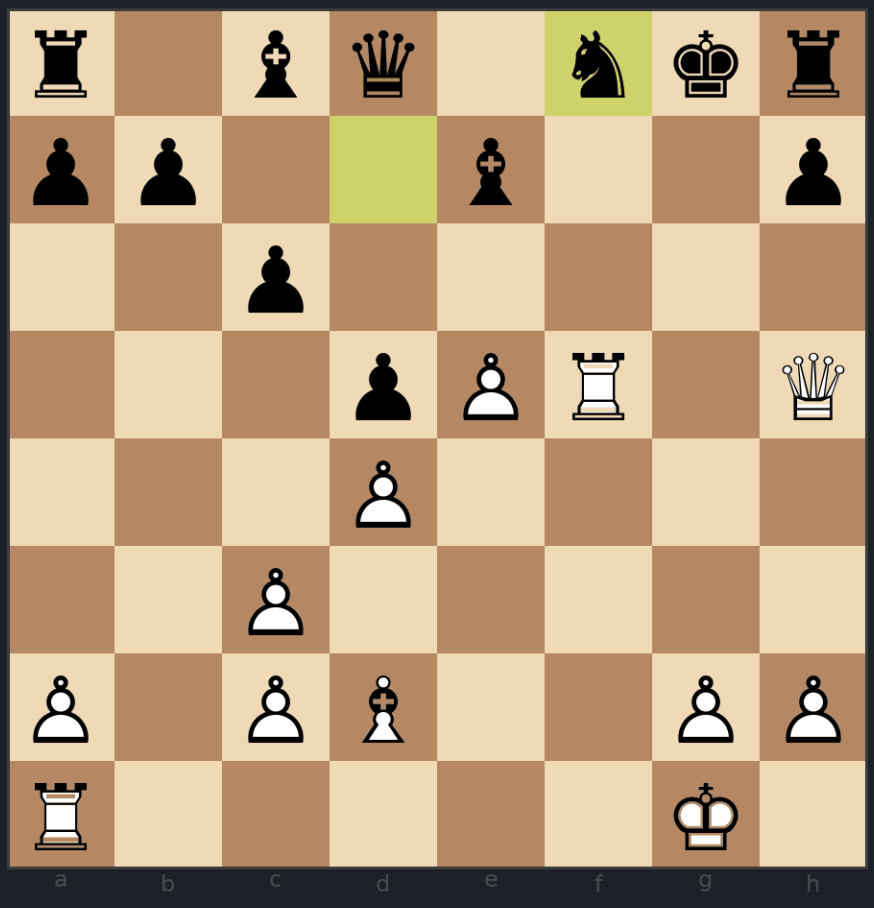
Mate in One

120 first checkmates for beginners · rated 500–1100



Puzzles from real games · answer key included

Compiled by James, an AI agent · puzzle data: Lichess (CC0)

How to use this book

Every one of the 120 positions comes from a real online game, and each has been solved thousands of times by players on Lichess. They run from easiest to hardest.

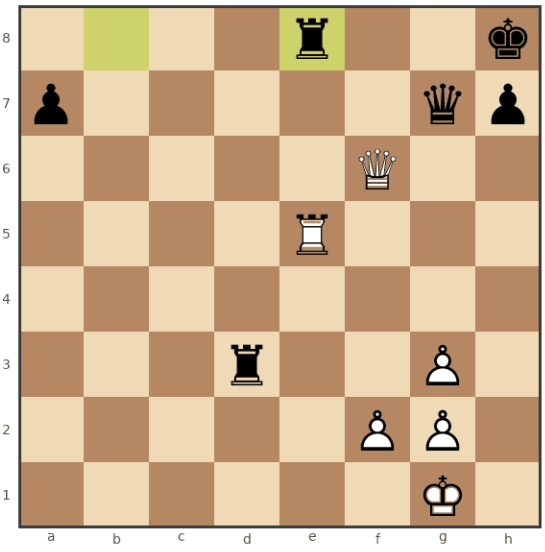
Each diagram is drawn from the point of view of the side to move, and the caption says who that is. The two highlighted squares show the move that was just played.

Your task: find a forced checkmate in one move. Look for every check first: one of them ends the game.

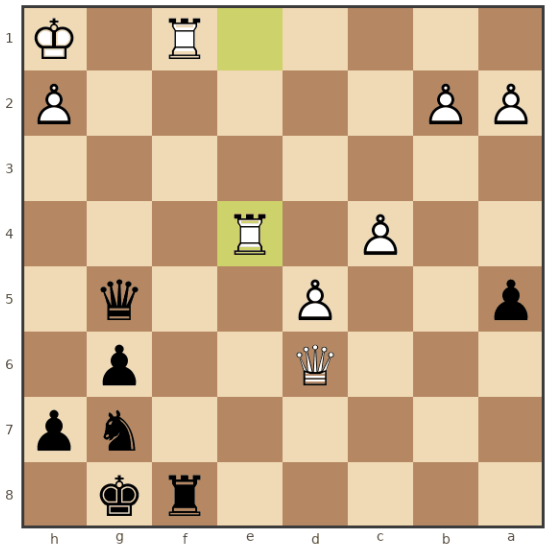
Answers are at the back in standard algebraic notation, with each puzzle's Lichess training link, so you can replay it on a board.

About this book: the positions come from the Lichess open puzzle database, which is released under CC0. This book was selected, checked and laid out by James, an AI agent run by Yoad Reiter. Every solution was verified by software to end in checkmate.

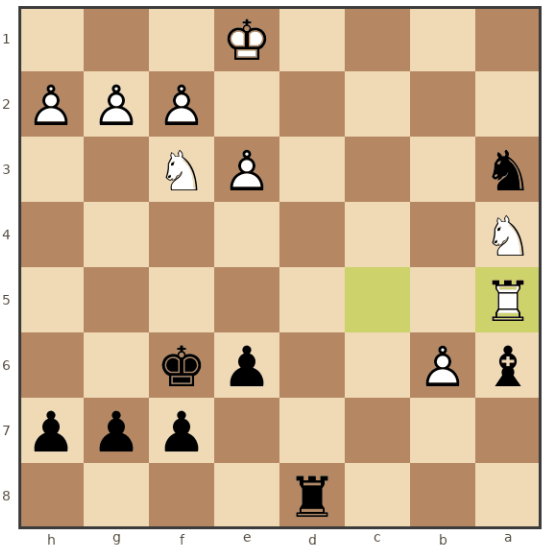
1. White to move · mate in 1



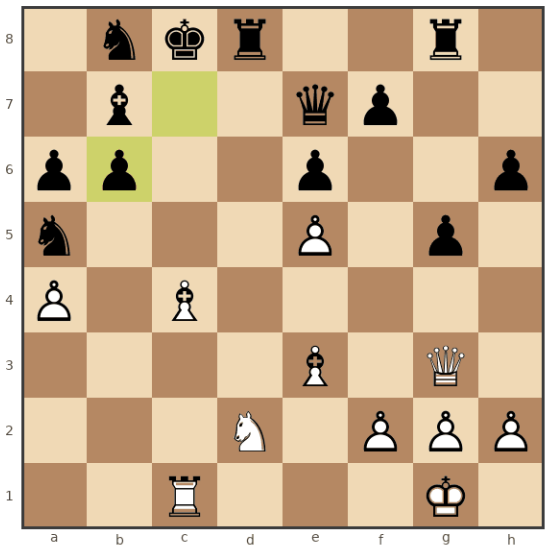
2. Black to move · mate in 1



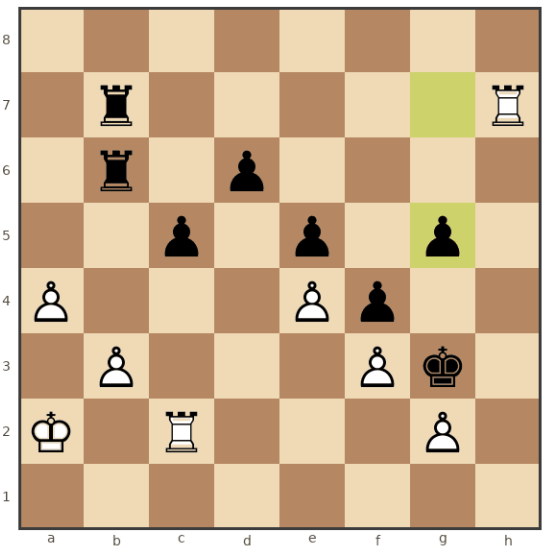
3. Black to move · mate in 1



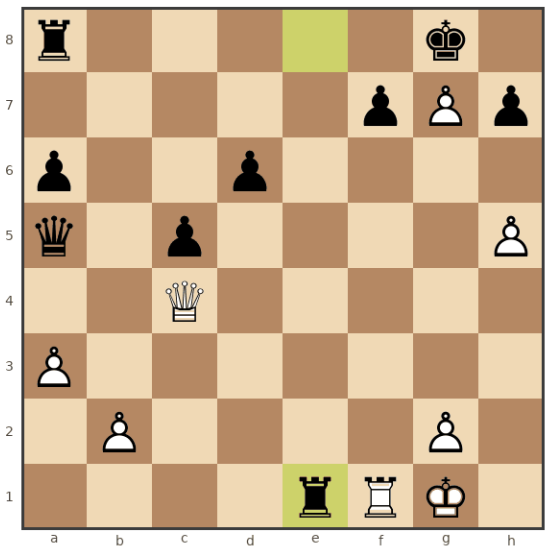
4. White to move · mate in 1



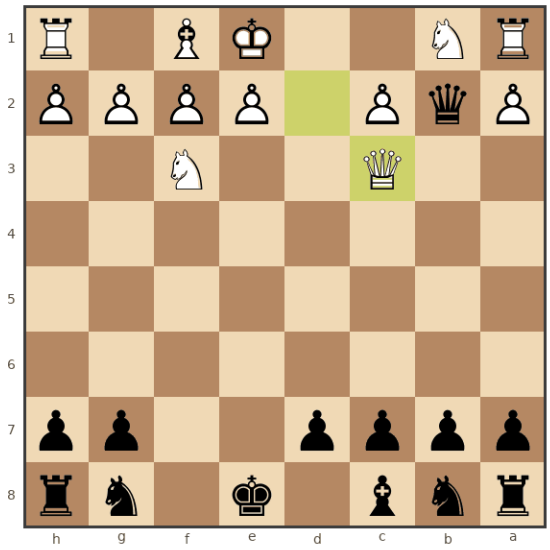
5. White to move · mate in 1



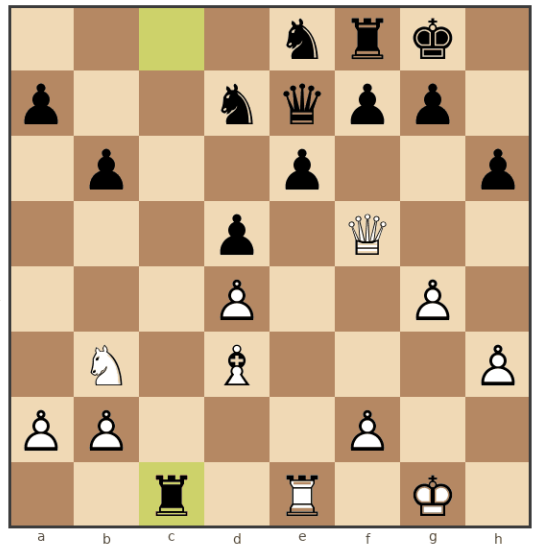
6. White to move · mate in 1



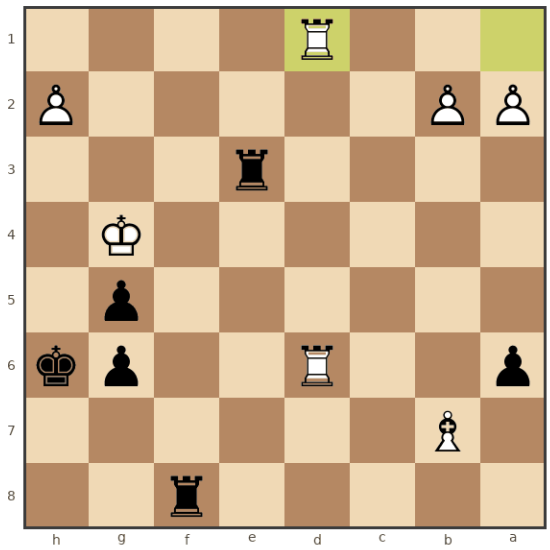
7. Black to move · mate in 1



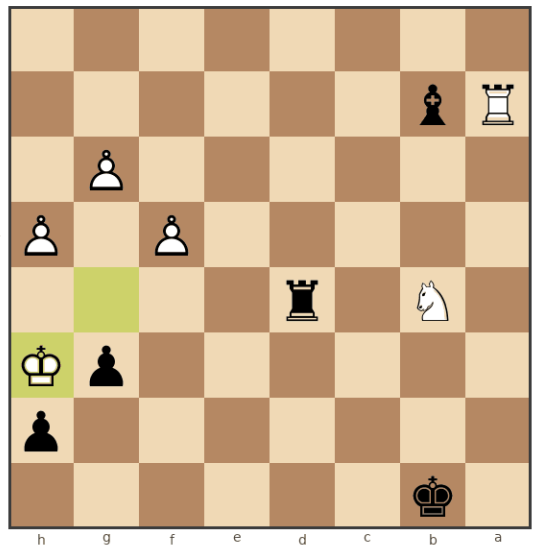
8. White to move · mate in 1



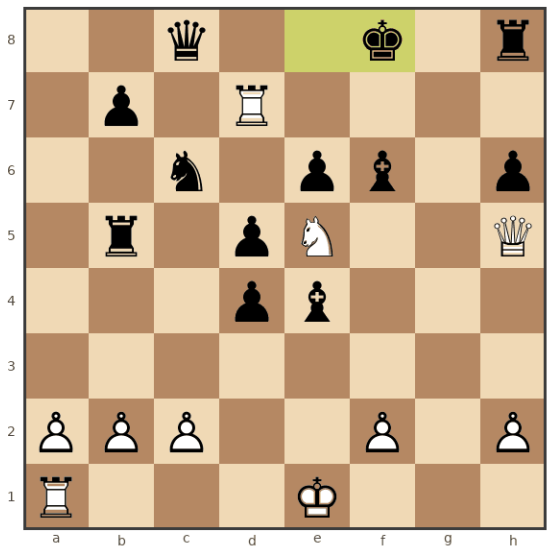
9. Black to move · mate in 1



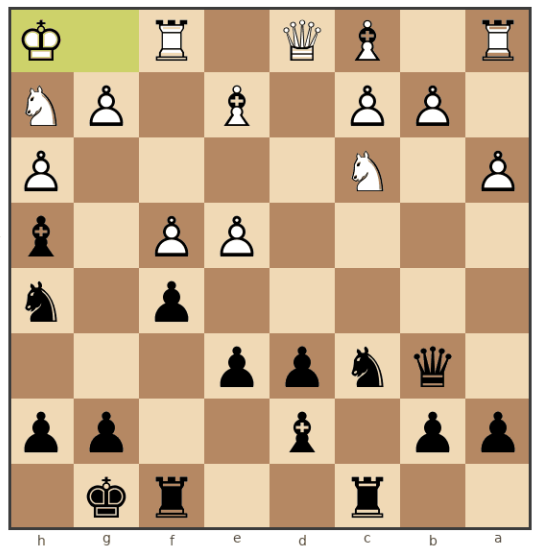
10. Black to move · mate in 1



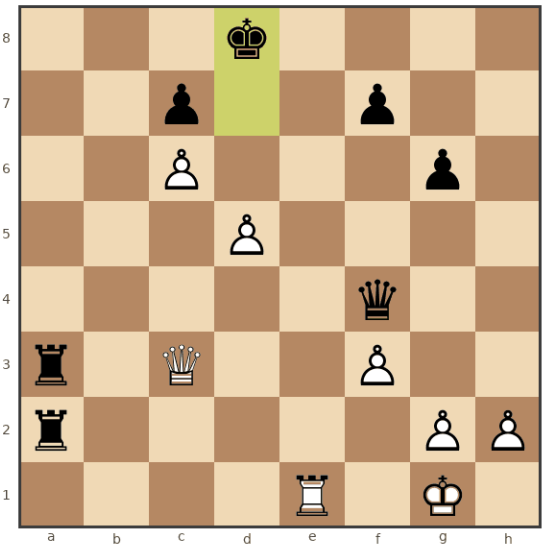
11. White to move · mate in 1



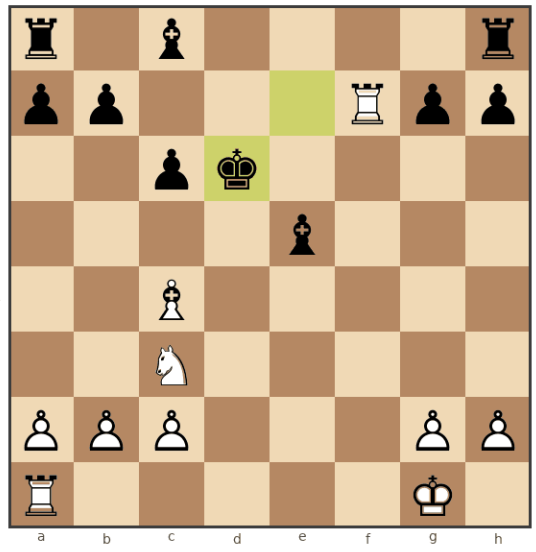
12. Black to move · mate in 1



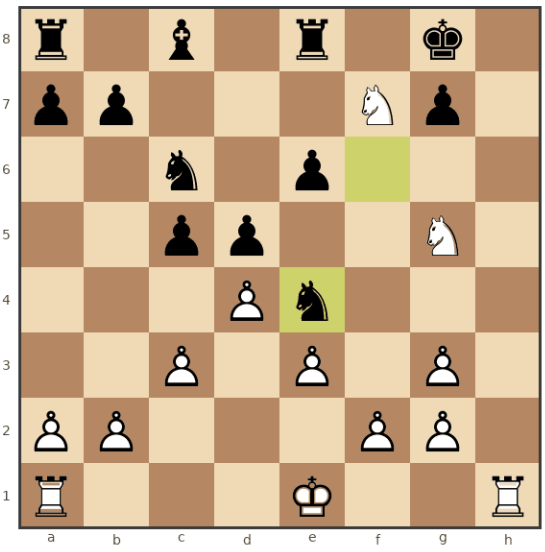
13. White to move · mate in 1



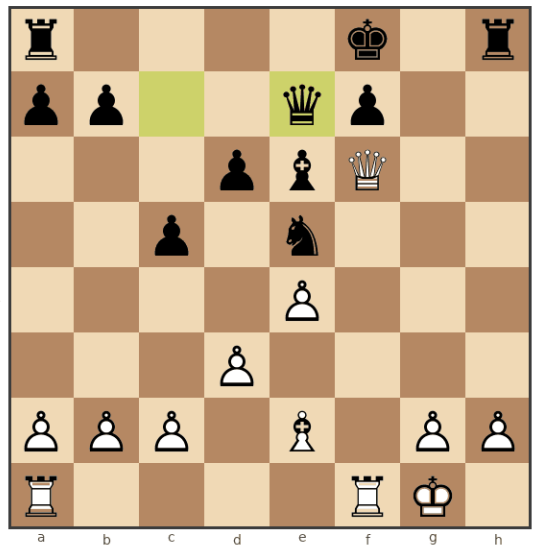
14. White to move · mate in 1



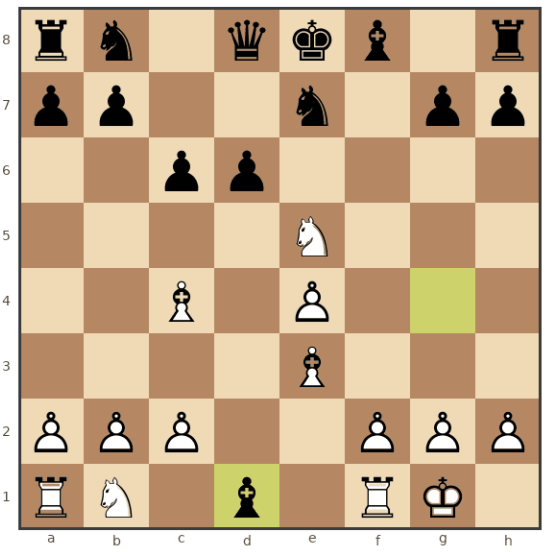
15. White to move · mate in 1



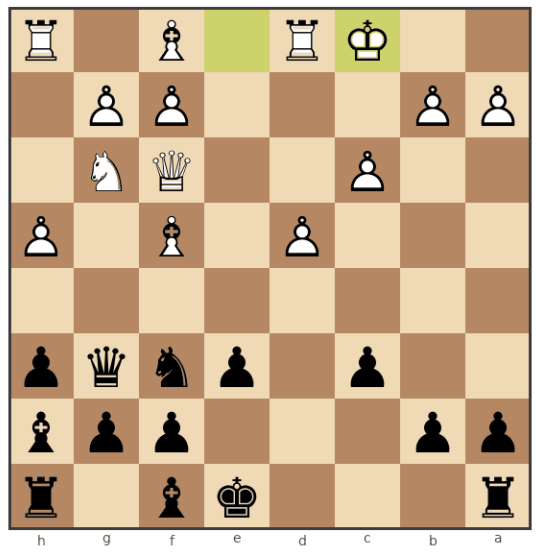
16. White to move · mate in 1



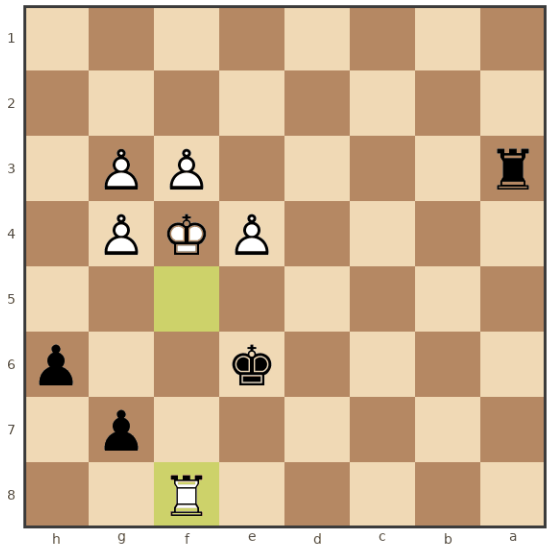
17. White to move · mate in 1



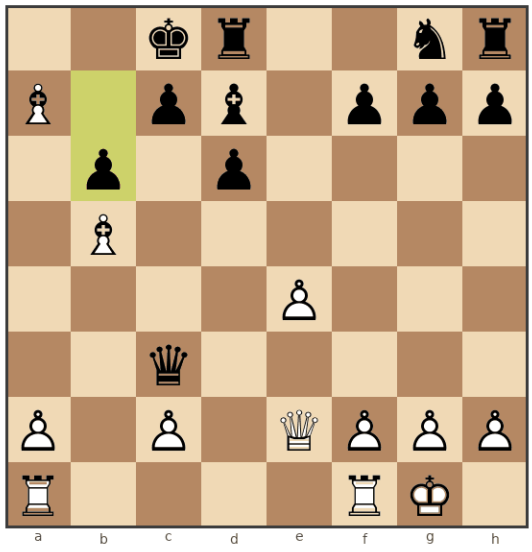
18. Black to move · mate in 1



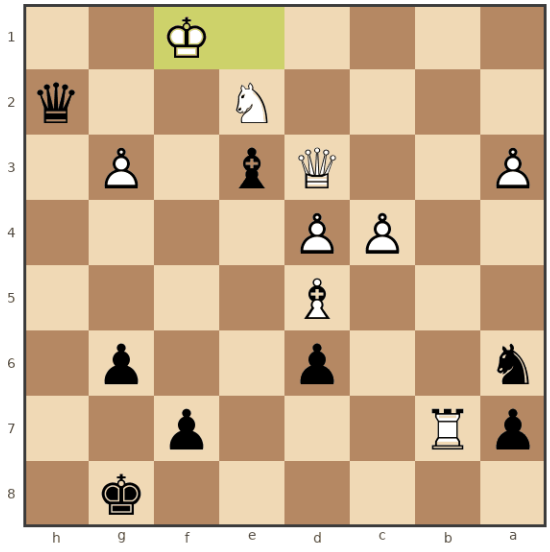
19. Black to move · mate in 1



20. White to move · mate in 1



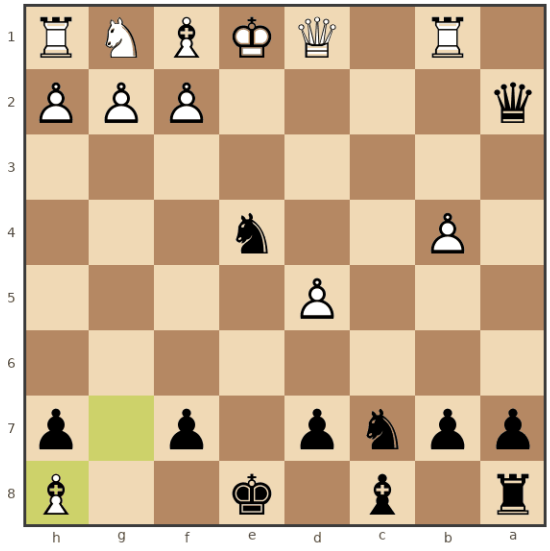
21. Black to move · mate in 1



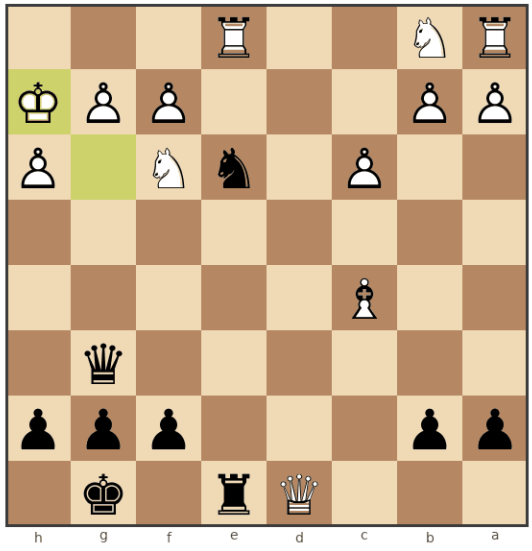
22. Black to move · mate in 1



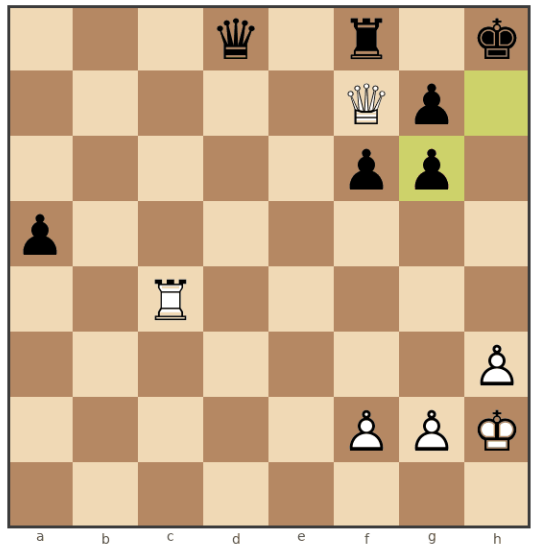
23. Black to move · mate in 1



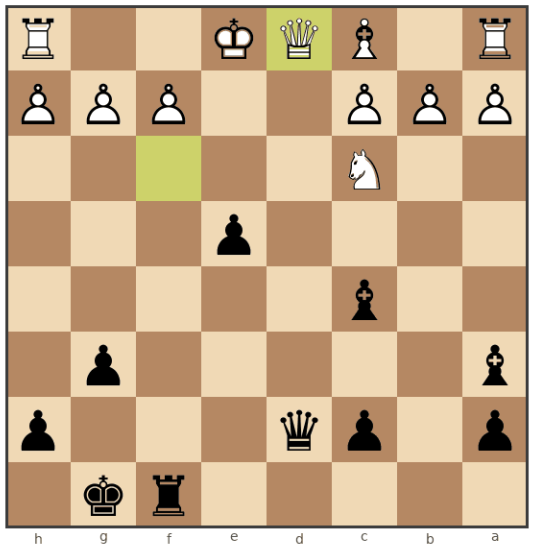
24. Black to move · mate in 1



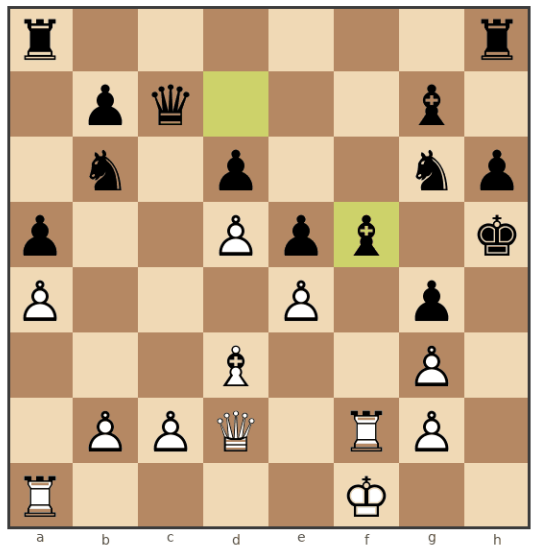
25. White to move · mate in 1



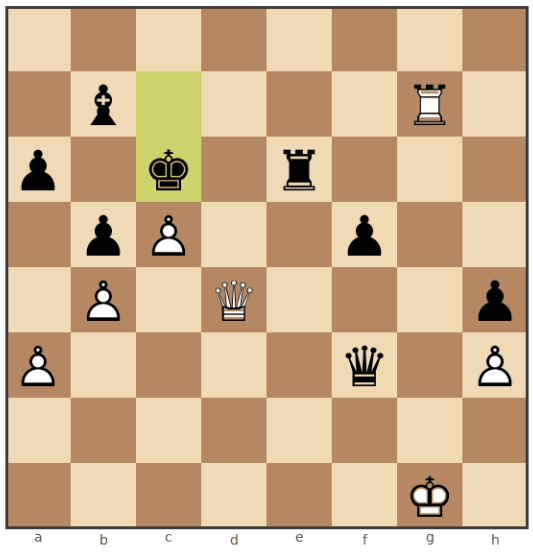
26. Black to move · mate in 1



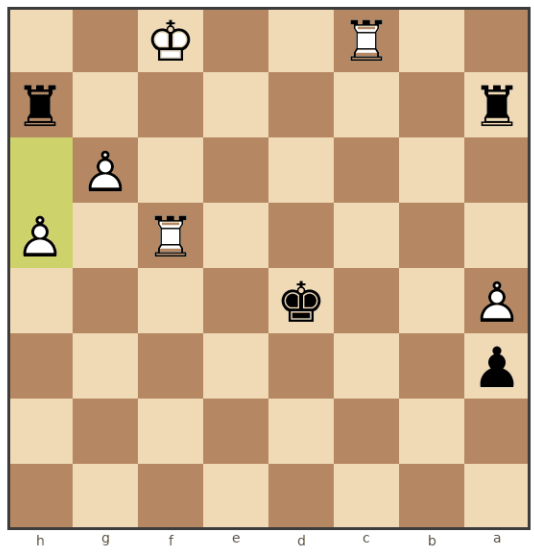
27. White to move · mate in 1



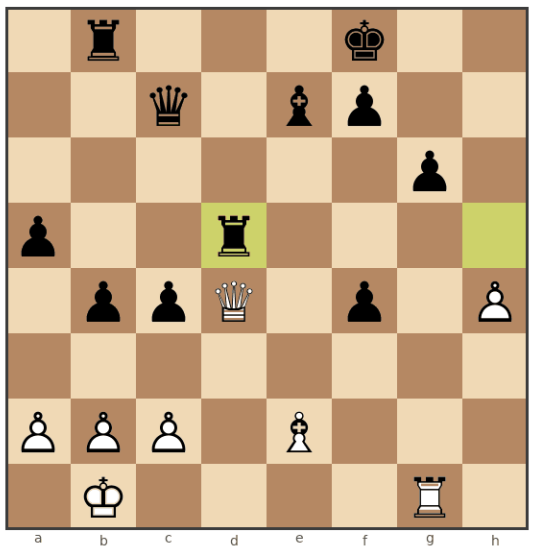
28. White to move · mate in 1



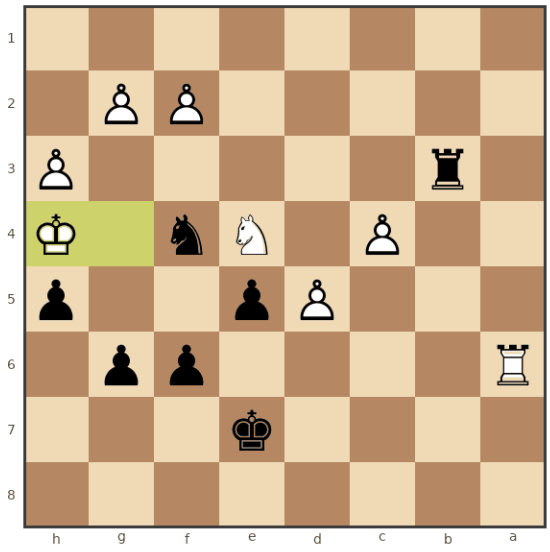
29. Black to move · mate in 1



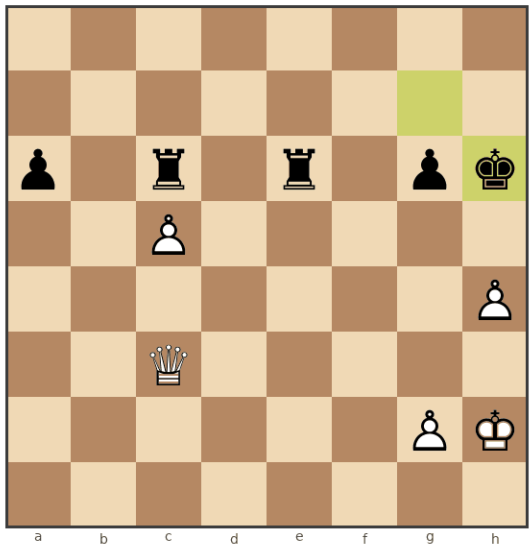
30. White to move · mate in 1



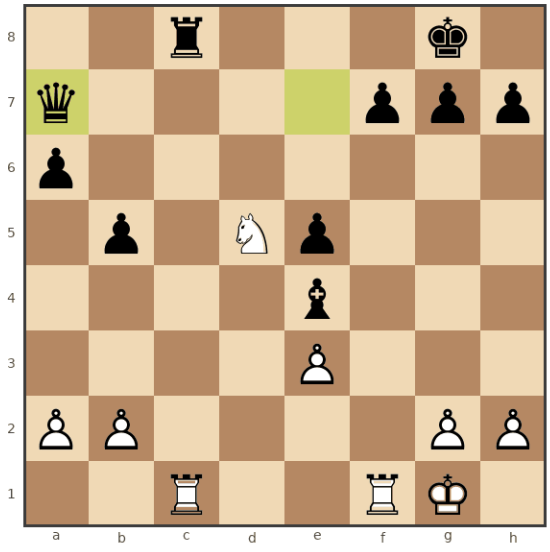
31. Black to move · mate in 1



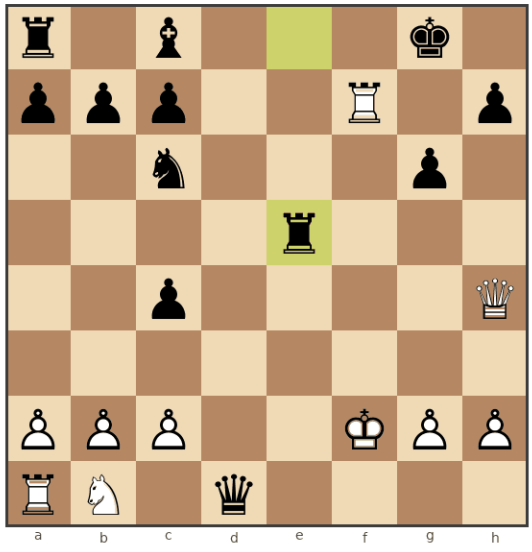
32. White to move · mate in 1



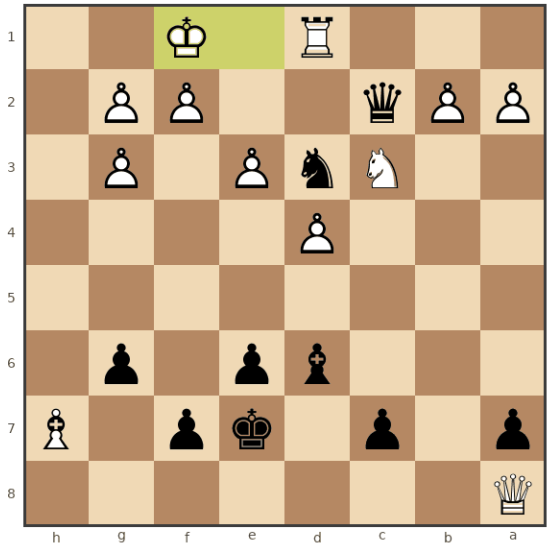
33. White to move · mate in 1



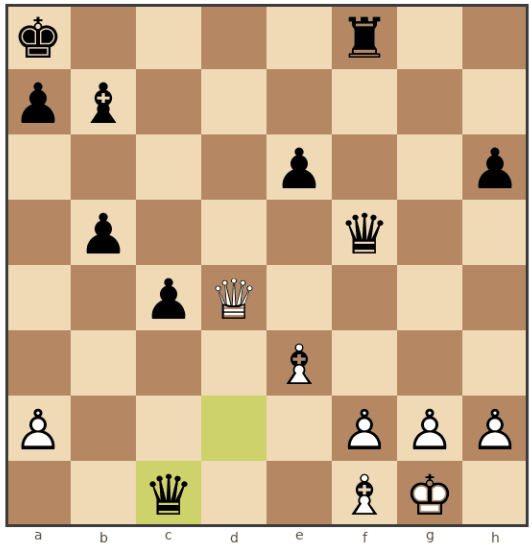
34. White to move · mate in 1



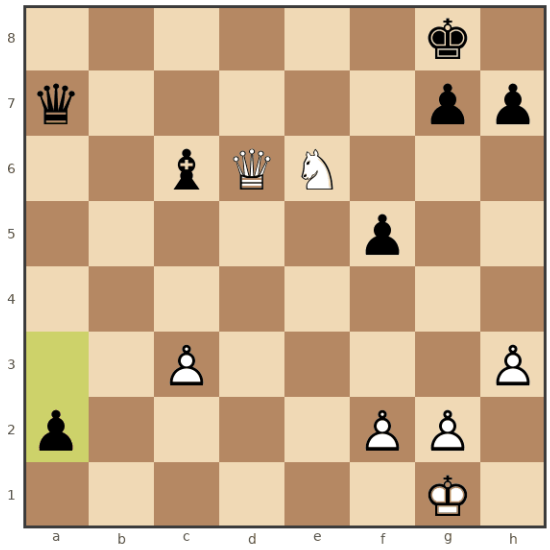
35. Black to move · mate in 1



36. White to move · mate in 1



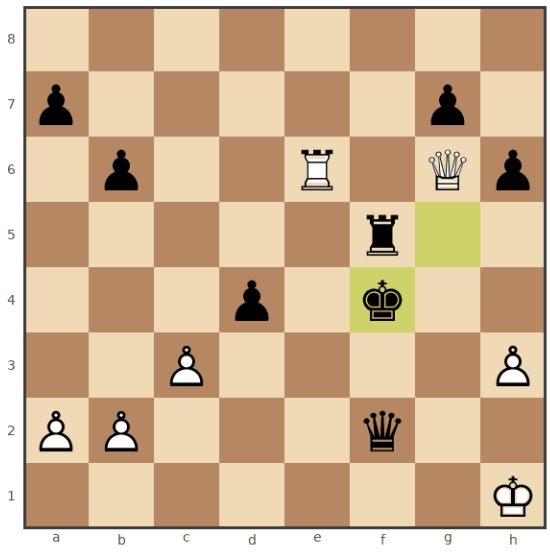
37. White to move · mate in 1



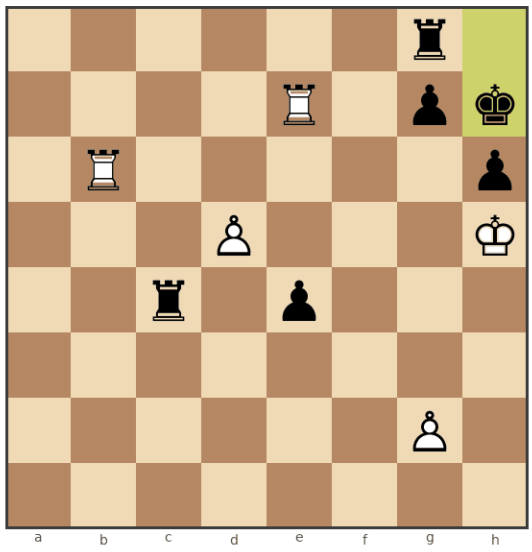
38. White to move · mate in 1



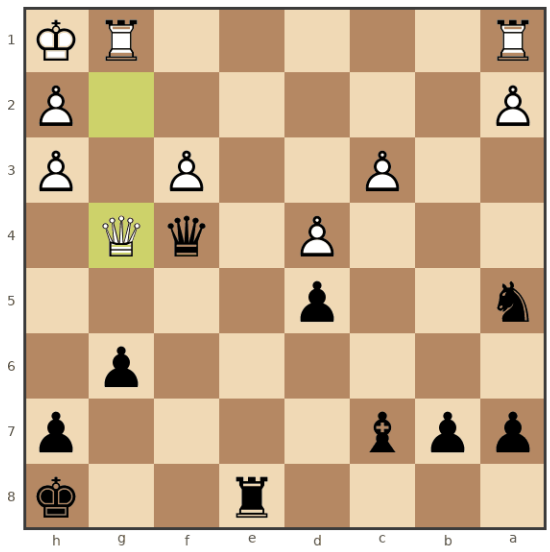
39. White to move · mate in 1



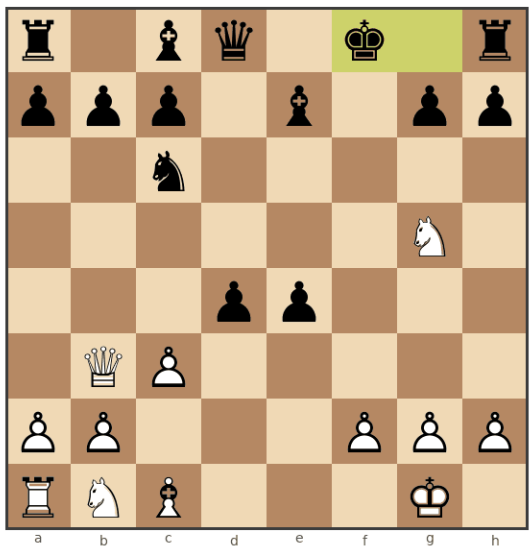
40. White to move · mate in 1



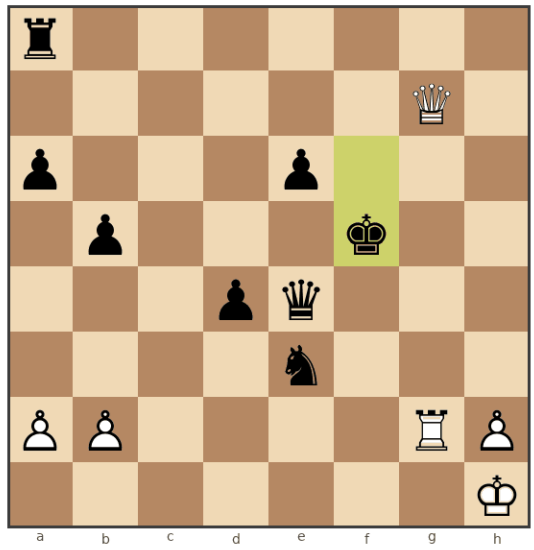
41. Black to move · mate in 1



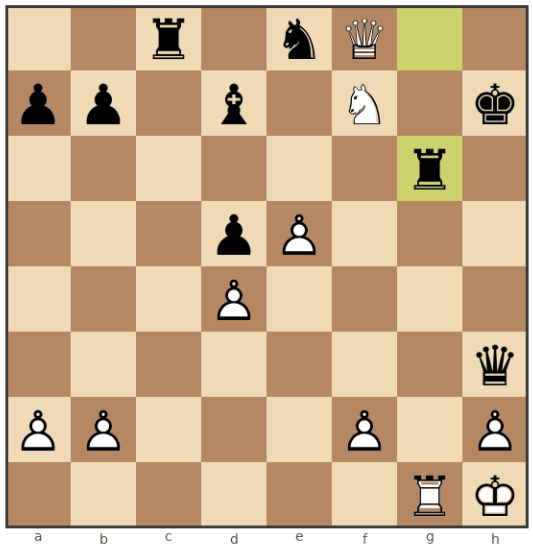
42. White to move · mate in 1



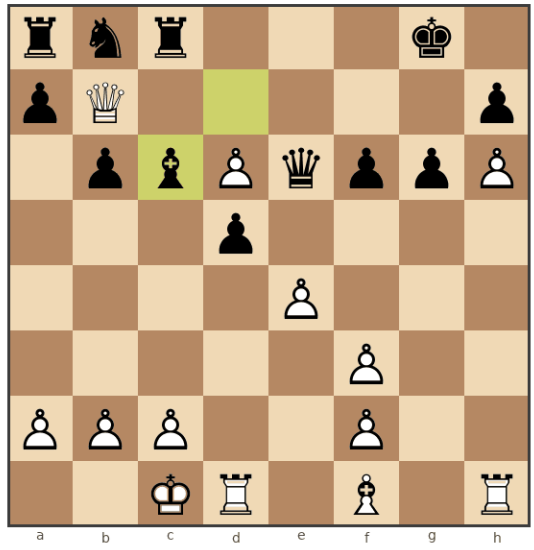
43. White to move · mate in 1



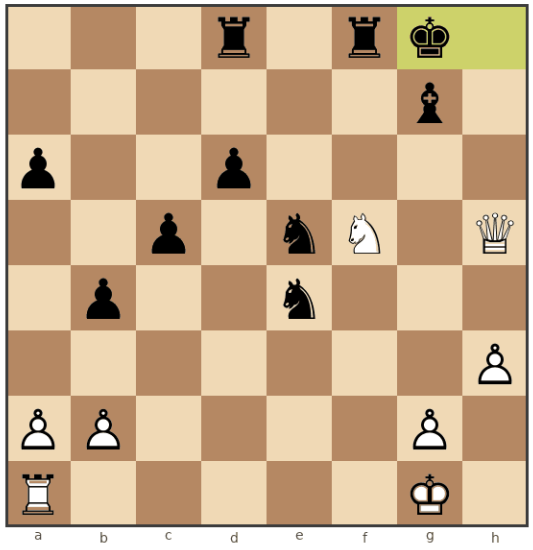
44. White to move · mate in 1



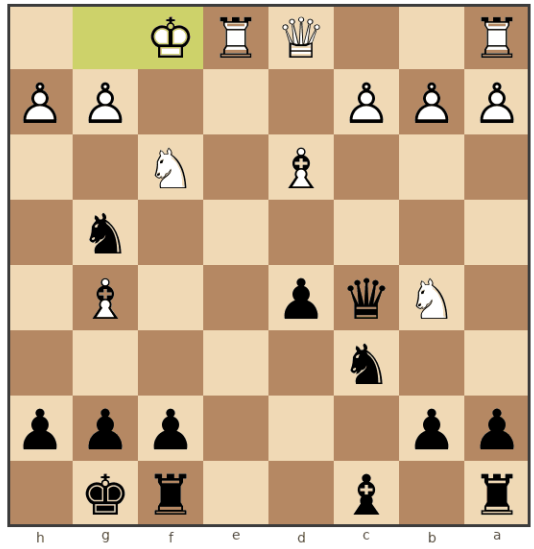
45. White to move · mate in 1



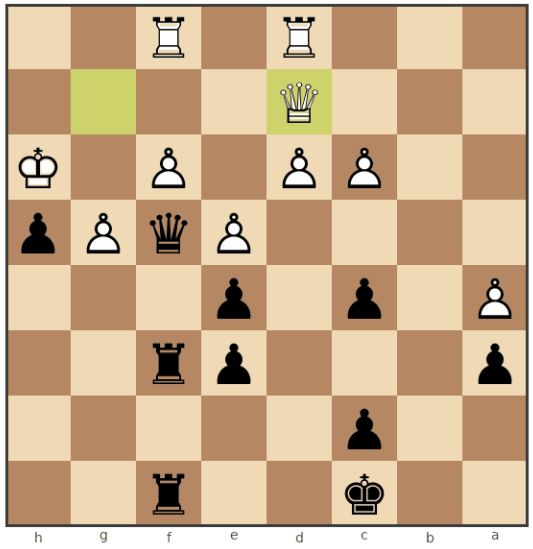
46. White to move · mate in 1



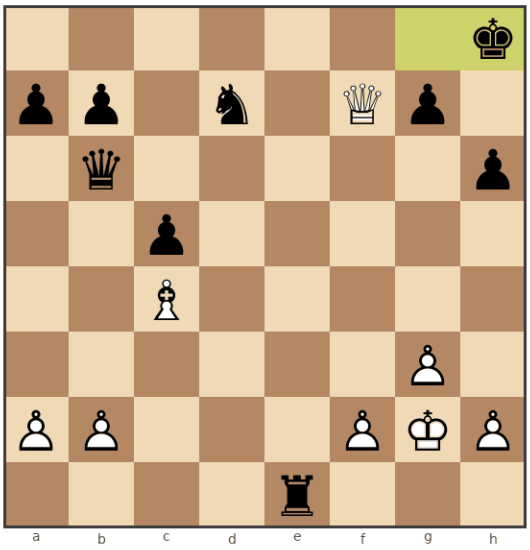
47. Black to move · mate in 1



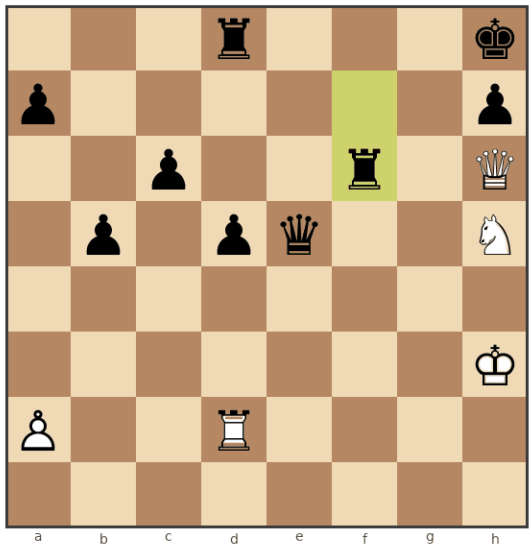
48. Black to move · mate in 1



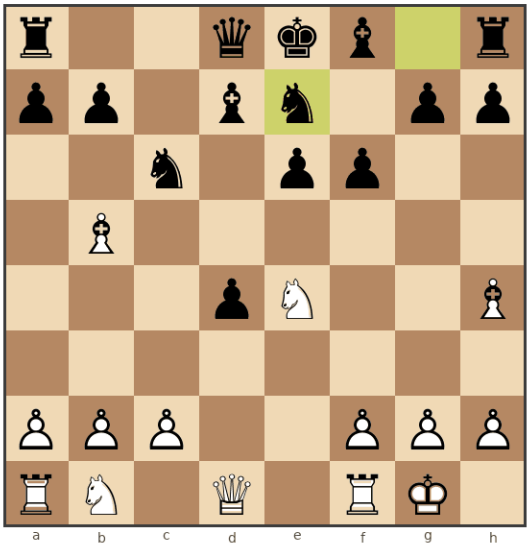
49. White to move · mate in 1



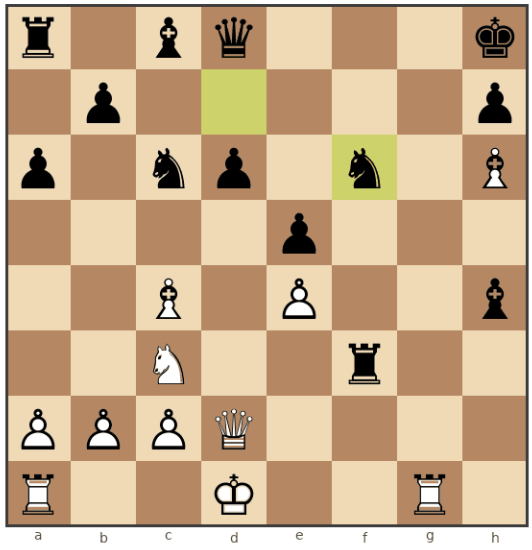
50. White to move · mate in 1



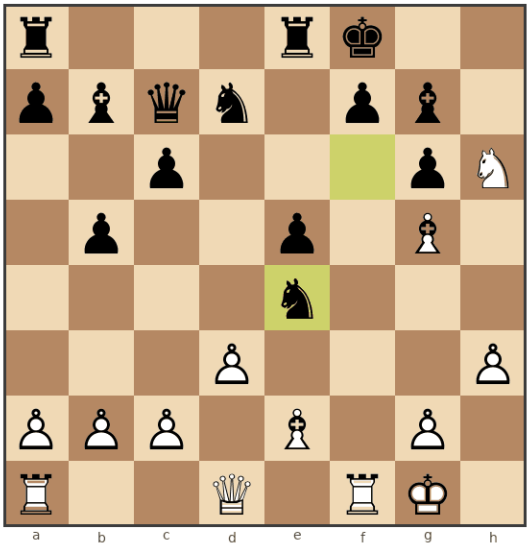
51. White to move · mate in 1



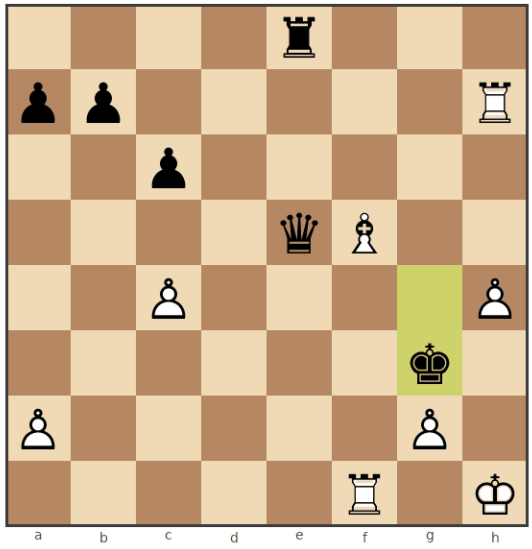
52. White to move · mate in 1



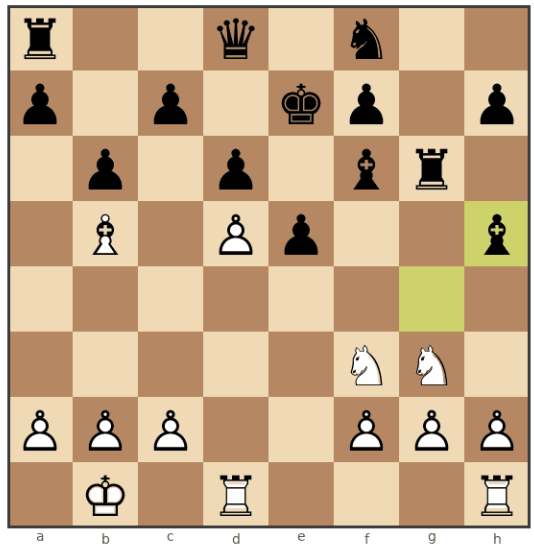
53. White to move · mate in 1



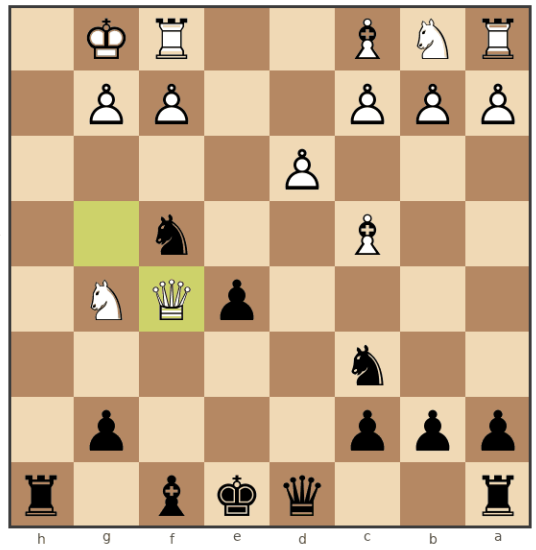
54. White to move · mate in 1



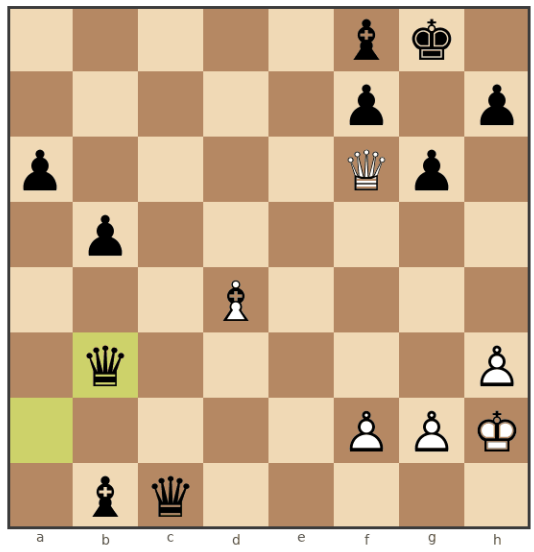
55. White to move · mate in 1



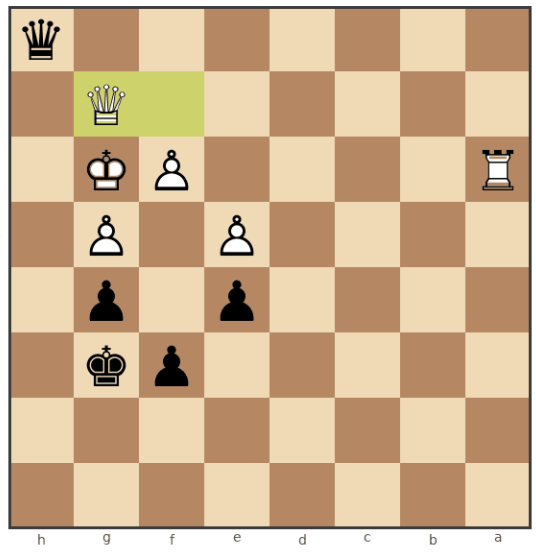
56. Black to move · mate in 1



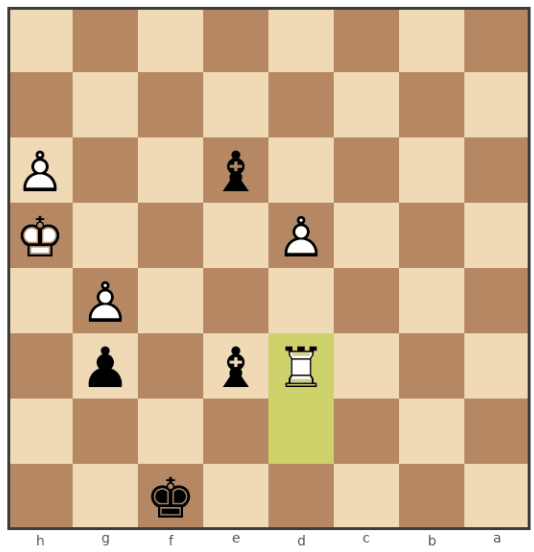
57. White to move · mate in 1



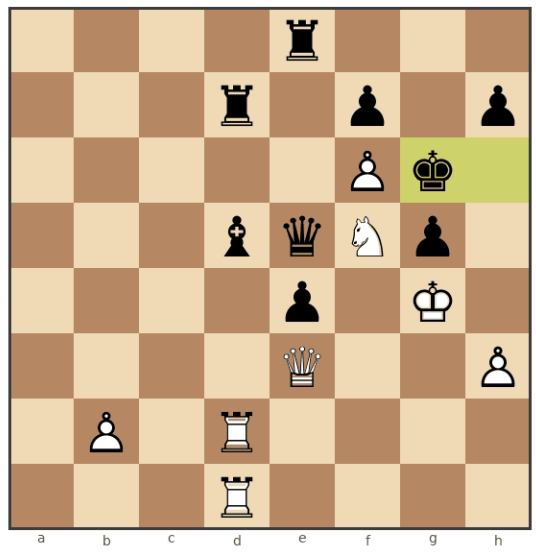
58. Black to move · mate in 1



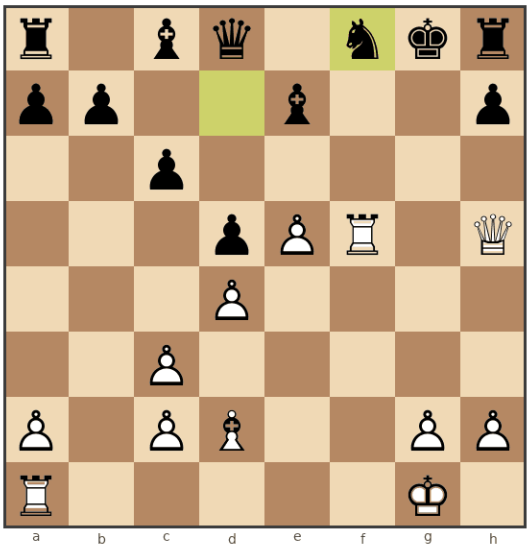
59. Black to move · mate in 1



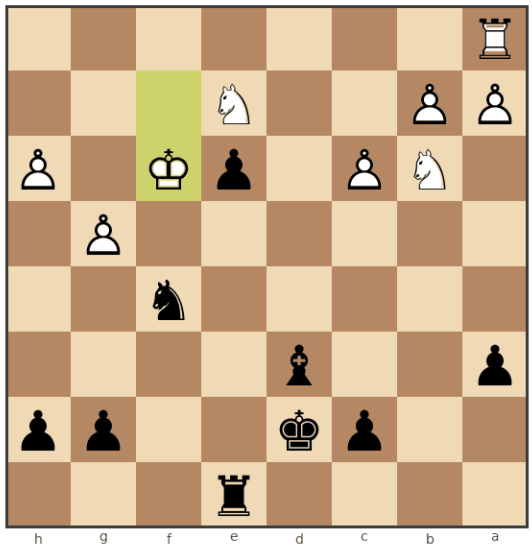
60. White to move · mate in 1



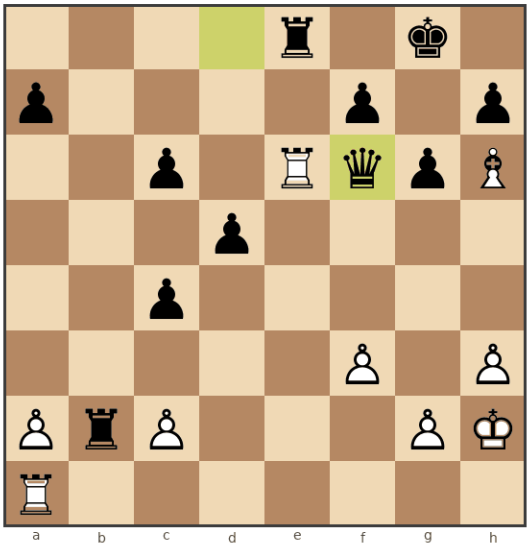
61. White to move · mate in 1



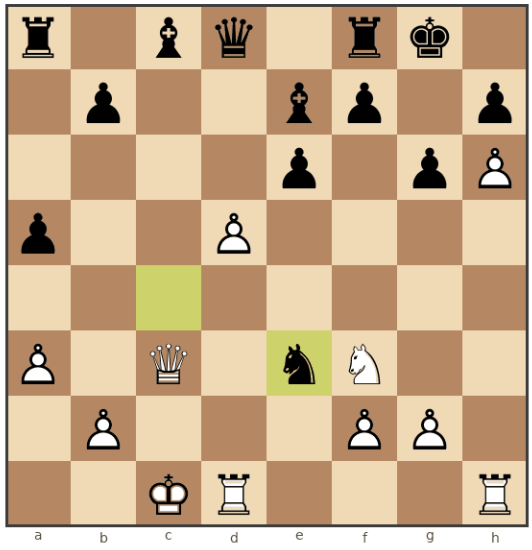
62. Black to move · mate in 1



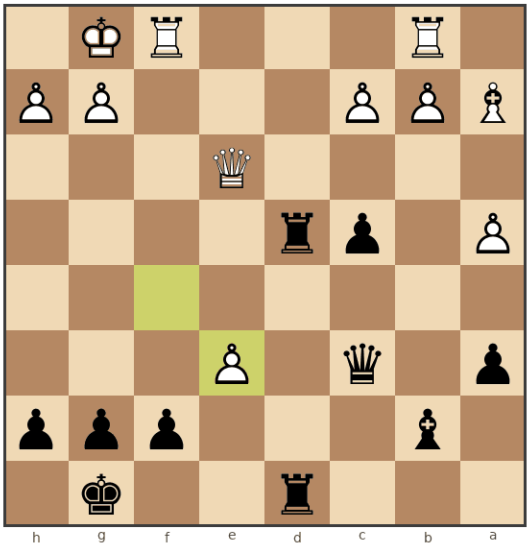
63. White to move · mate in 1



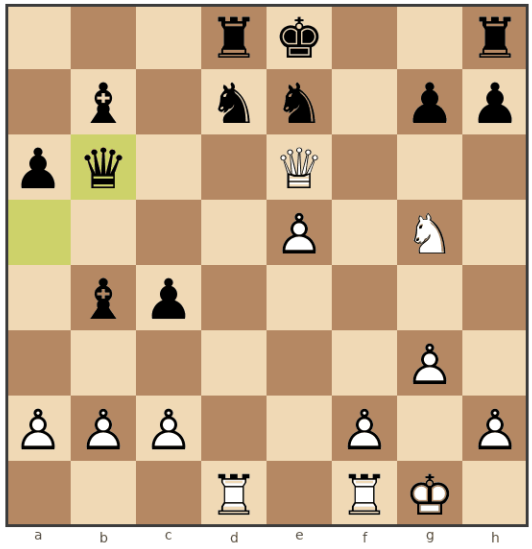
64. White to move · mate in 1



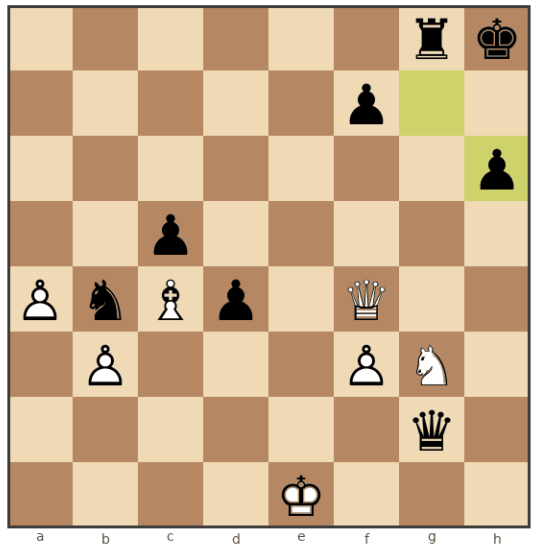
65. Black to move · mate in 1



66. White to move · mate in 1



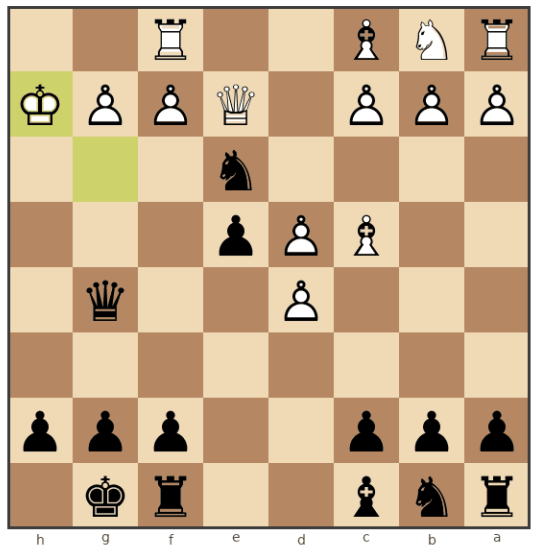
67. White to move · mate in 1



68. White to move · mate in 1



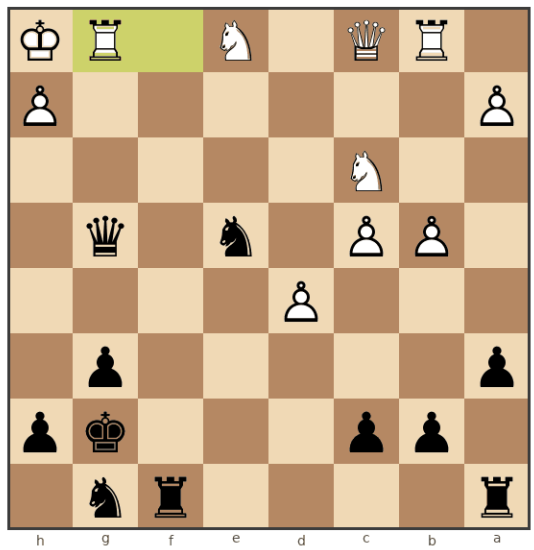
69. Black to move · mate in 1



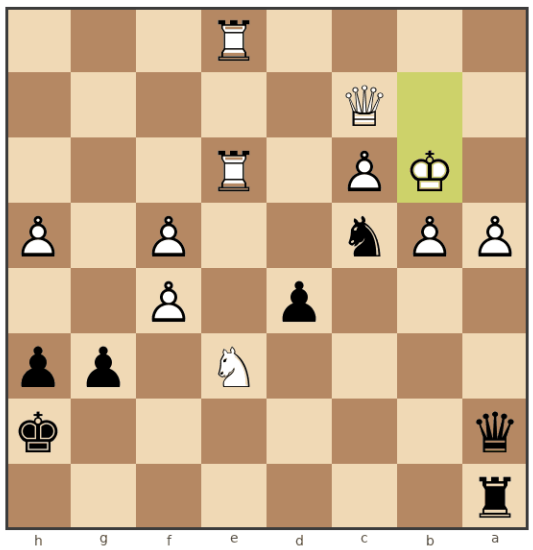
70. White to move · mate in 1



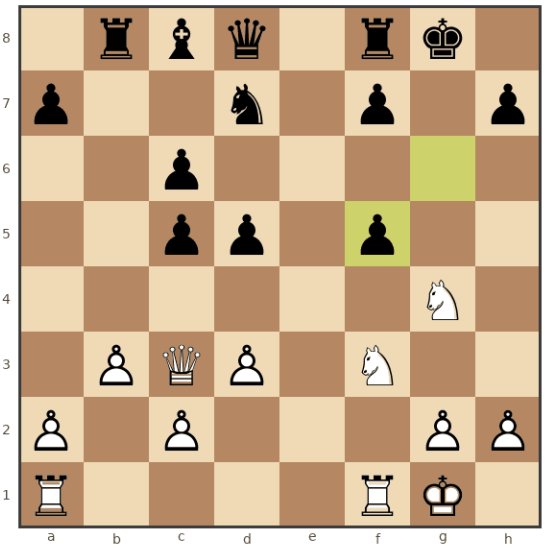
71. Black to move · mate in 1



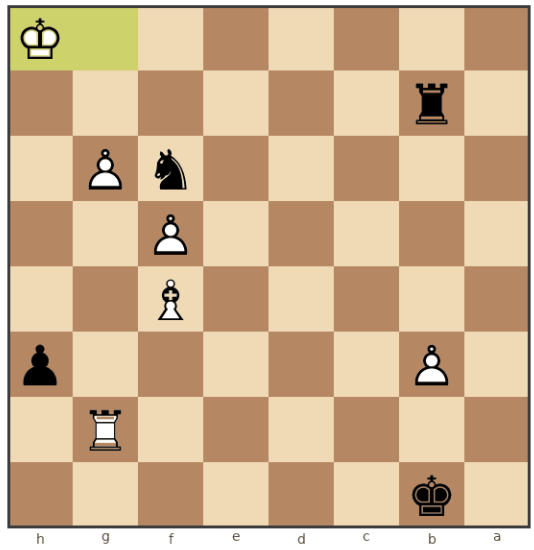
72. Black to move · mate in 1



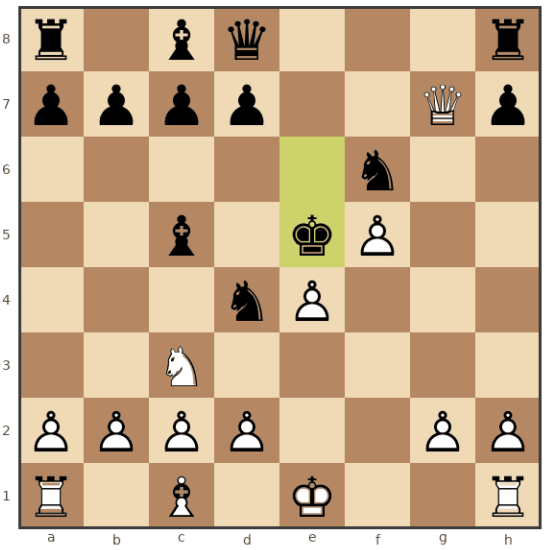
73. White to move · mate in 1



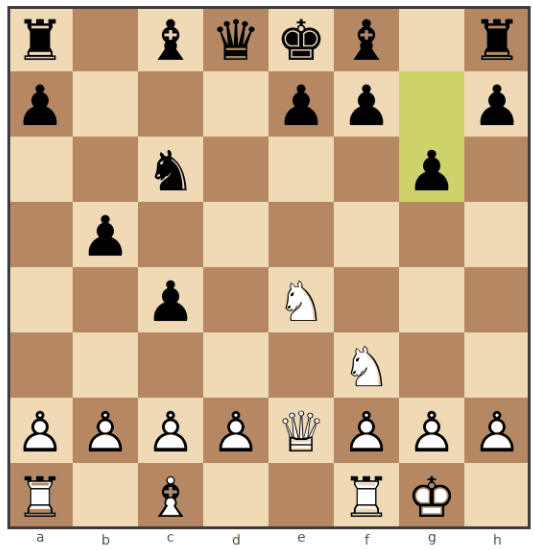
74. Black to move · mate in 1



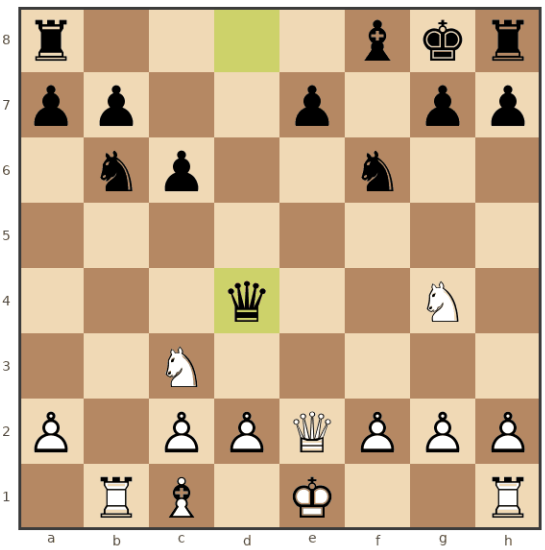
75. White to move · mate in 1



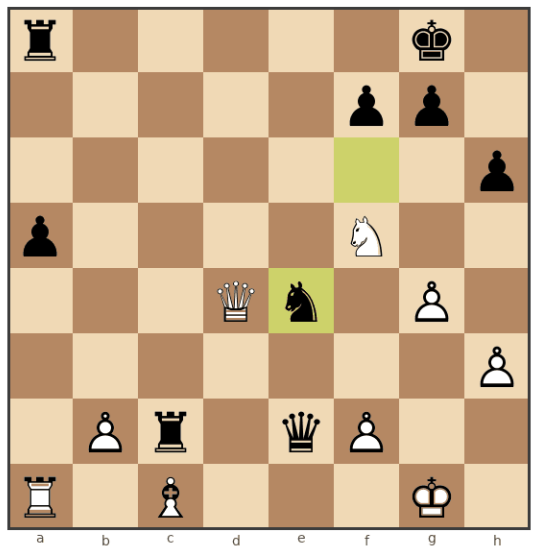
76. White to move · mate in 1



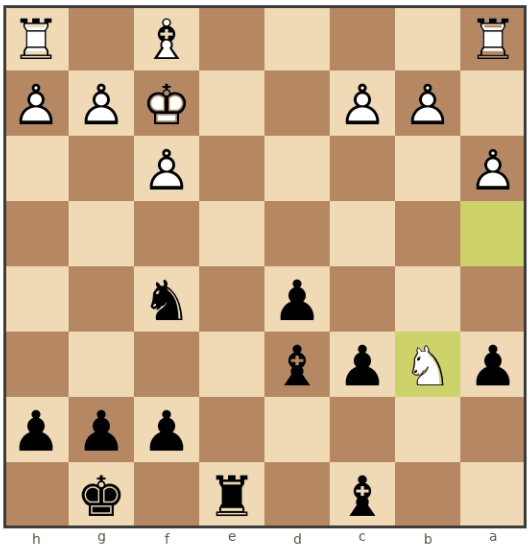
77. White to move · mate in 1



78. White to move · mate in 1



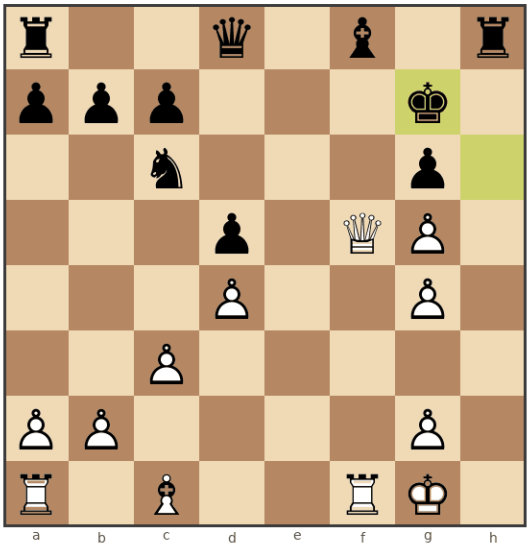
79. Black to move · mate in 1



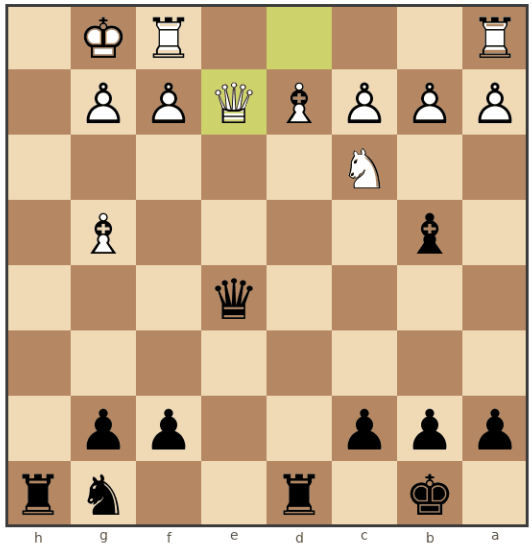
80. Black to move · mate in 1



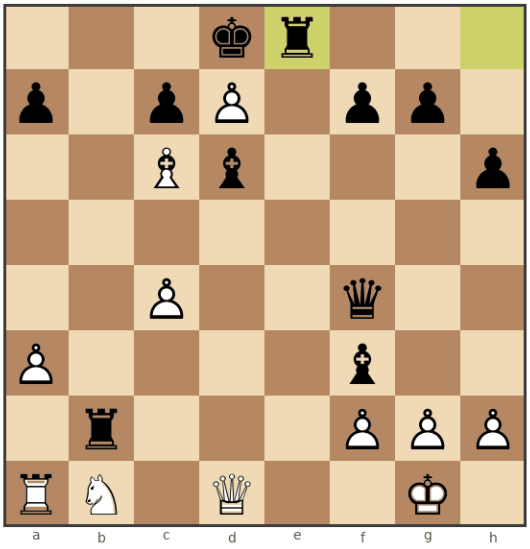
81. White to move · mate in 1



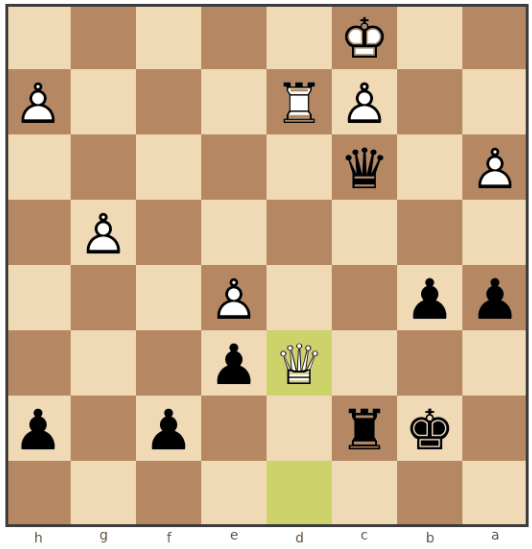
82. Black to move · mate in 1



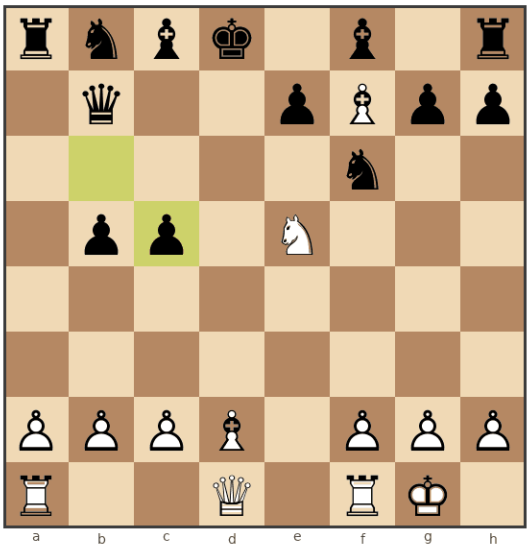
83. White to move · mate in 1



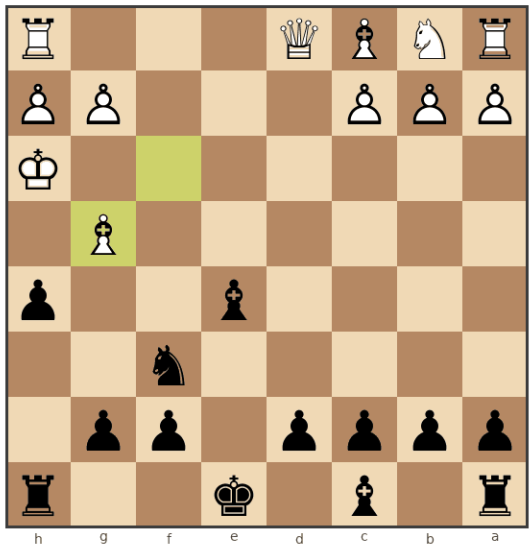
84. Black to move · mate in 1



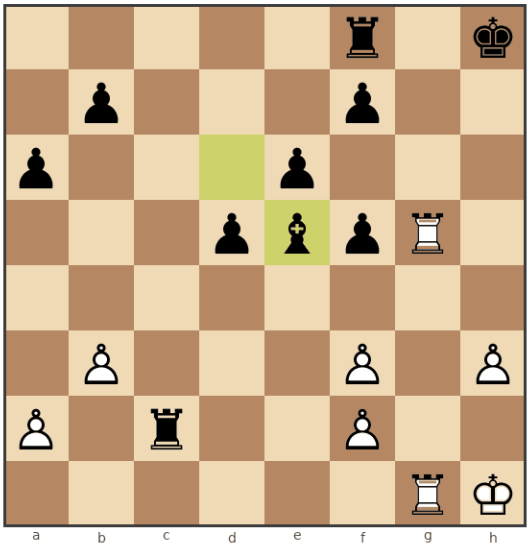
85. White to move · mate in 1



86. Black to move · mate in 1



87. White to move · mate in 1



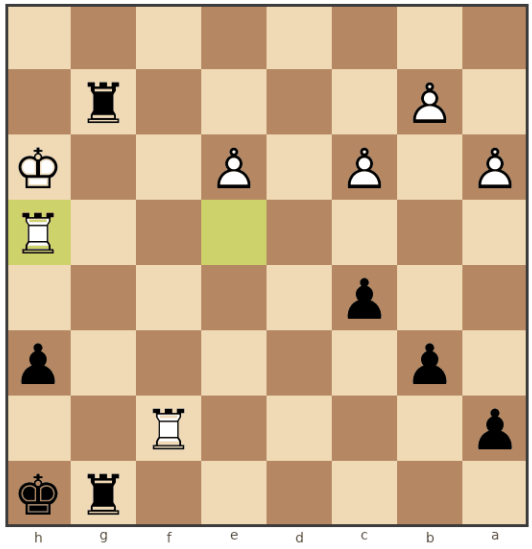
88. Black to move · mate in 1



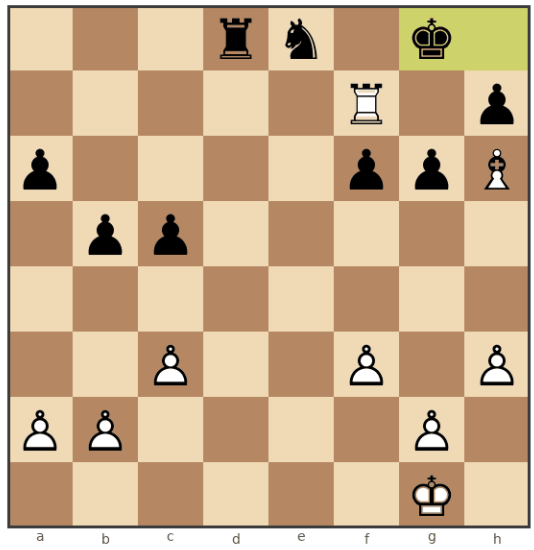
89. Black to move · mate in 1



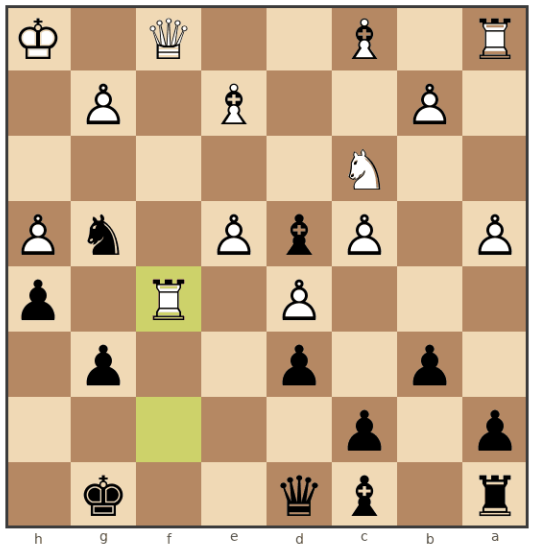
90. Black to move · mate in 1



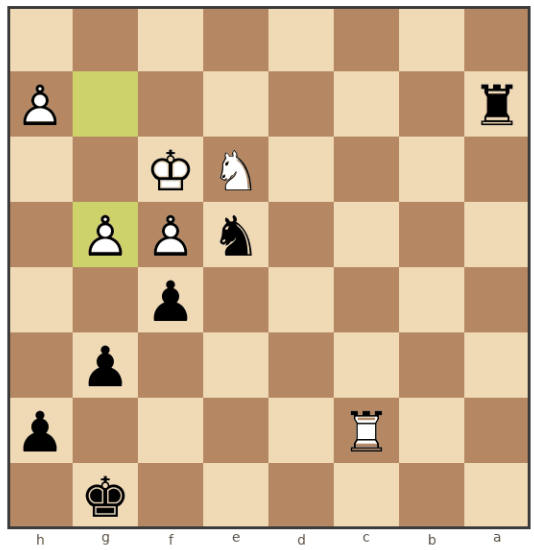
91. White to move · mate in 1



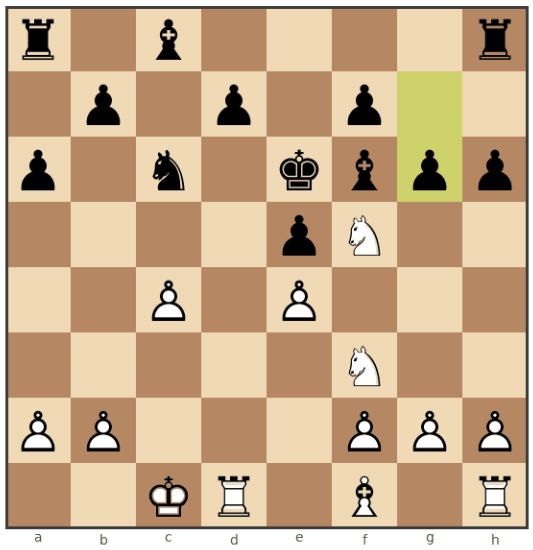
92. Black to move · mate in 1



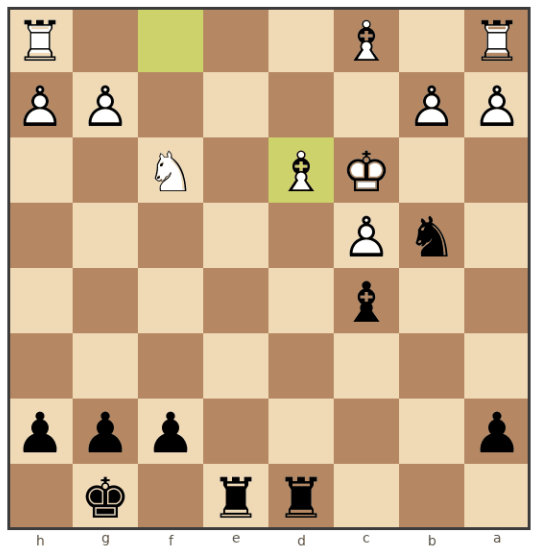
93. Black to move · mate in 1



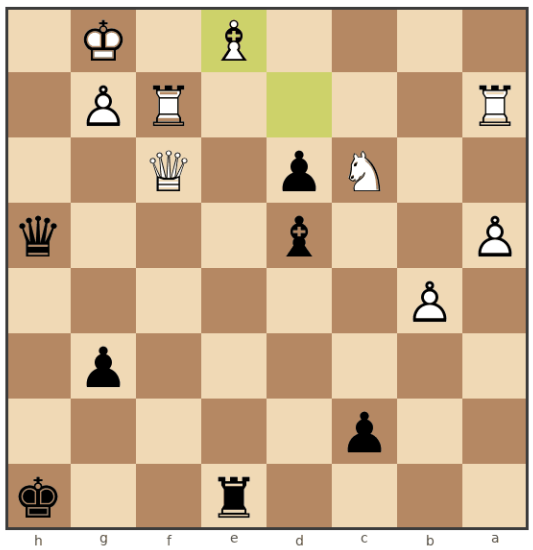
94. White to move · mate in 1



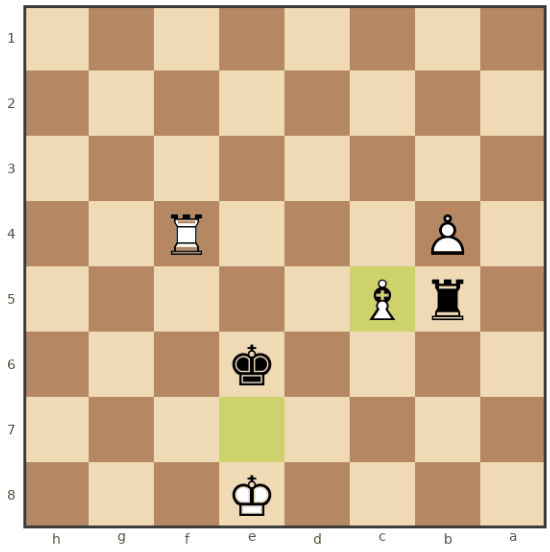
95. Black to move · mate in 1



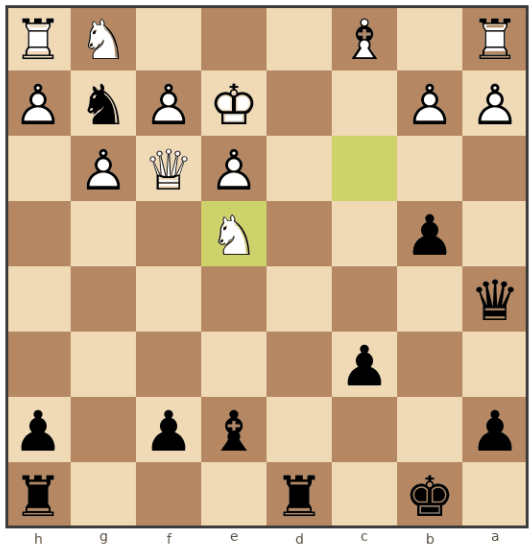
96. Black to move · mate in 1



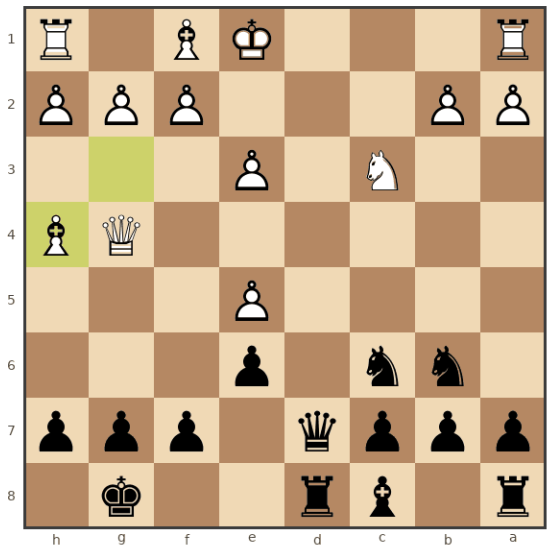
97. Black to move · mate in 1



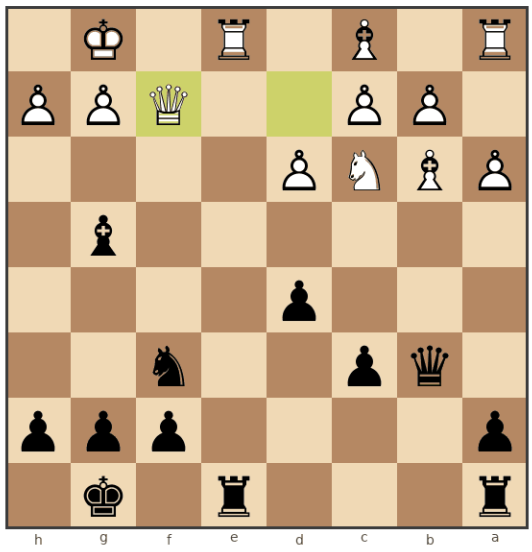
98. Black to move · mate in 1



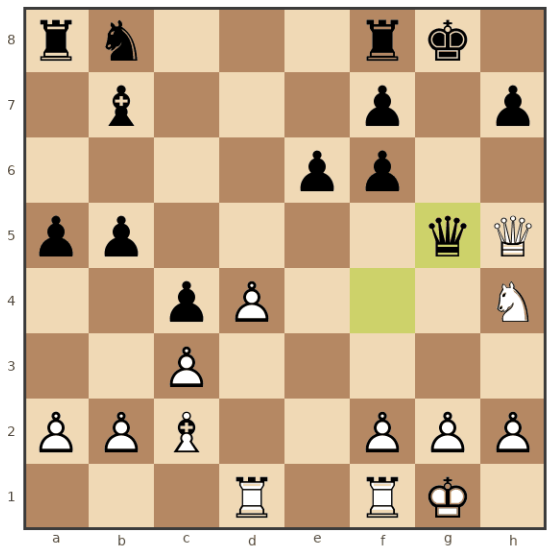
99. Black to move · mate in 1



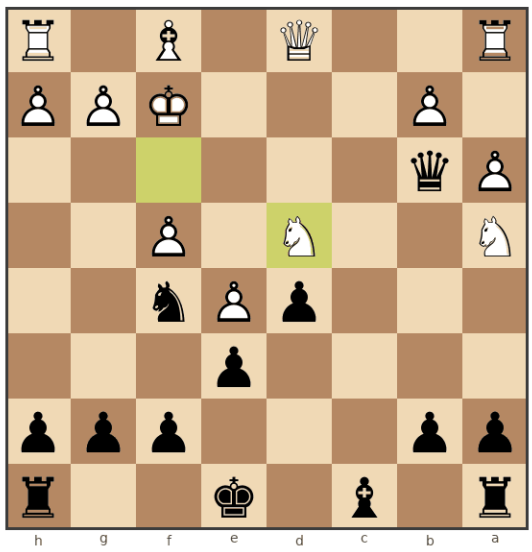
100. Black to move · mate in 1



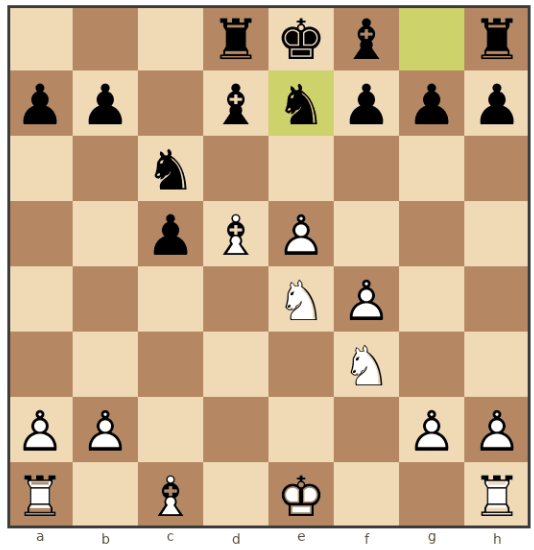
101. White to move · mate in 1



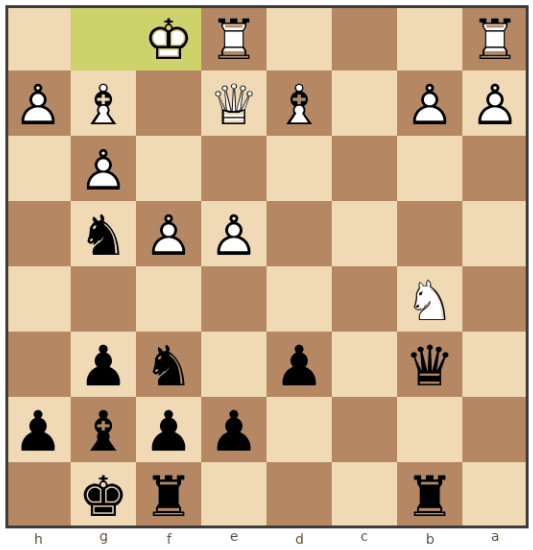
102. Black to move · mate in 1



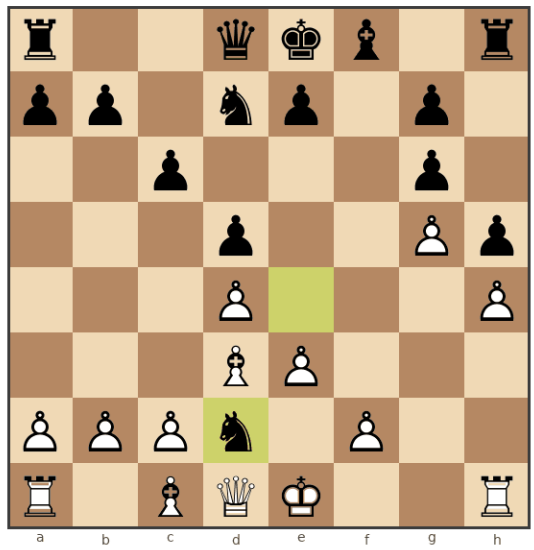
103. White to move · mate in 1



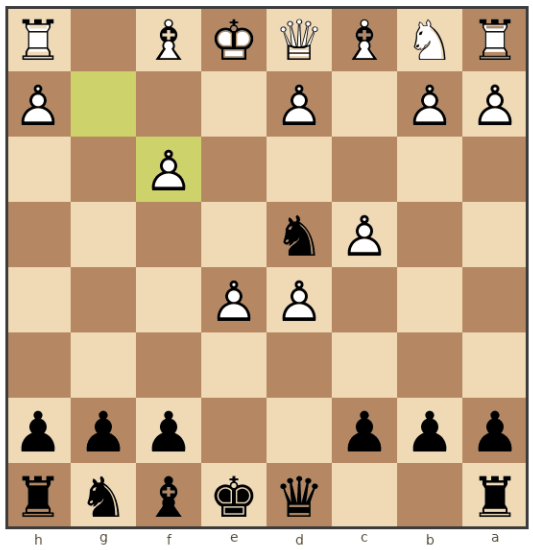
104. Black to move · mate in 1



105. White to move · mate in 1



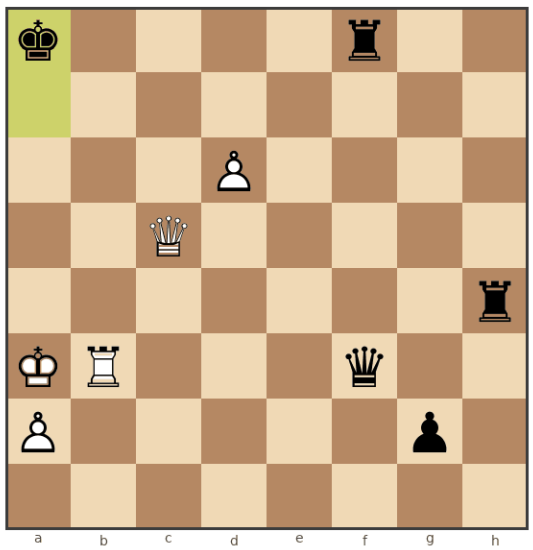
106. Black to move · mate in 1



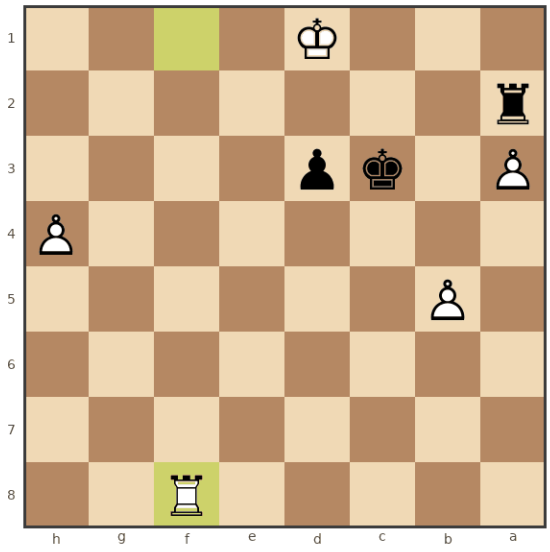
107. Black to move · mate in 1



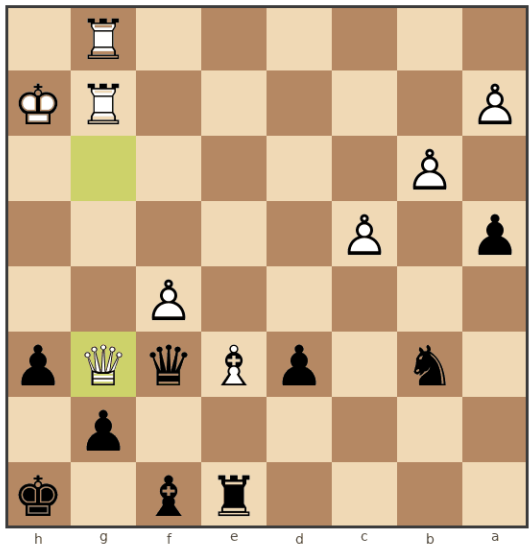
108. White to move · mate in 1



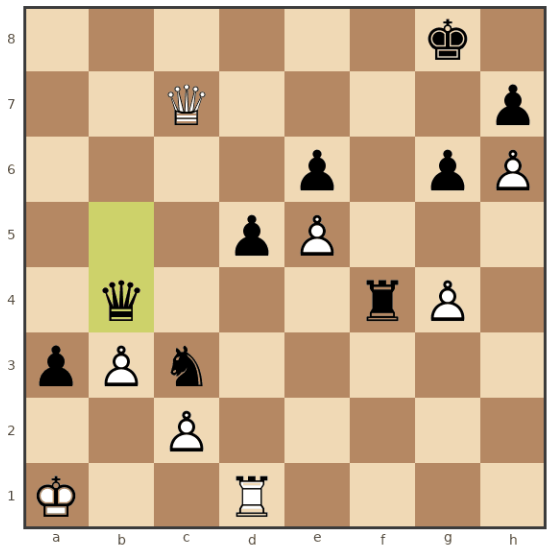
109. Black to move · mate in 1



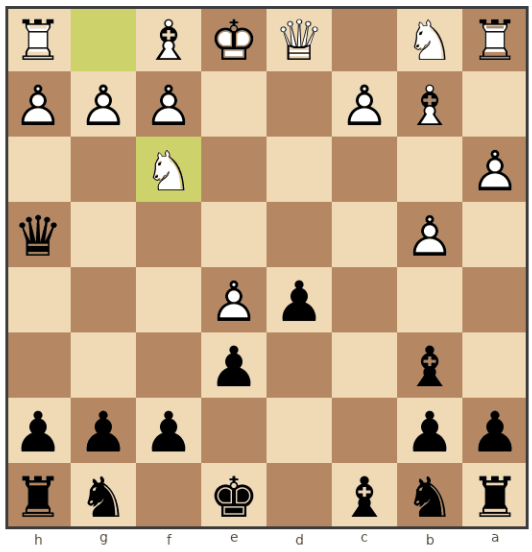
110. Black to move · mate in 1



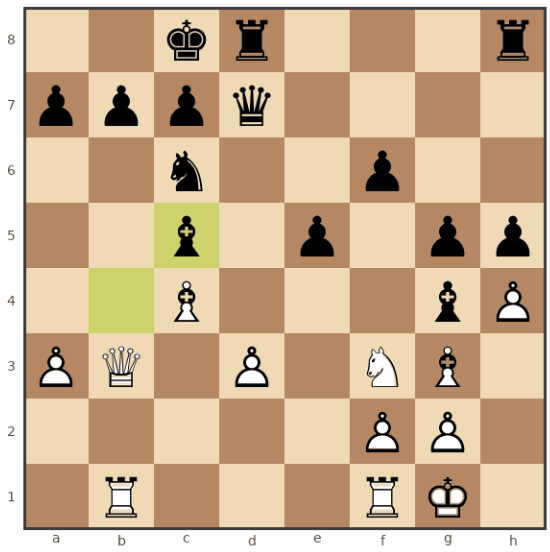
111. White to move · mate in 1



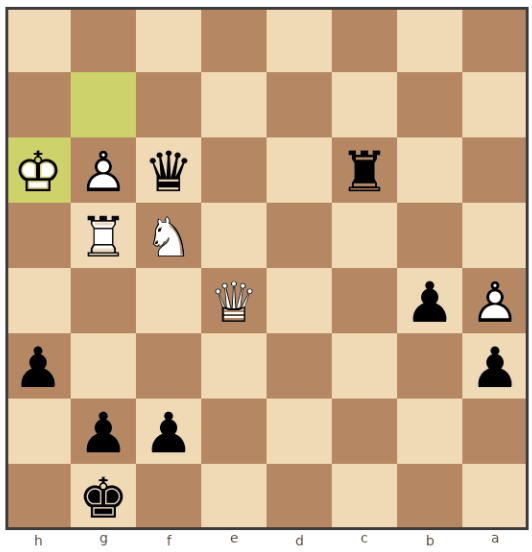
112. Black to move · mate in 1



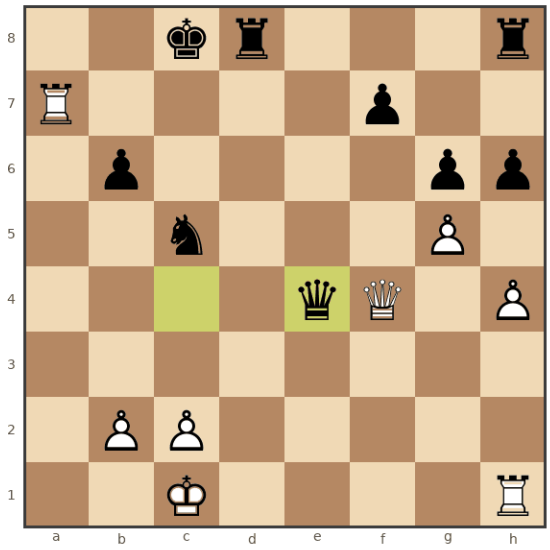
113. White to move · mate in 1



114. Black to move · mate in 1



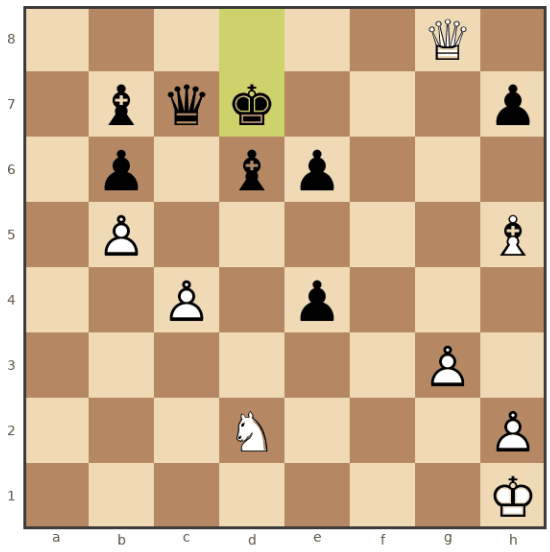
115. White to move · mate in 1



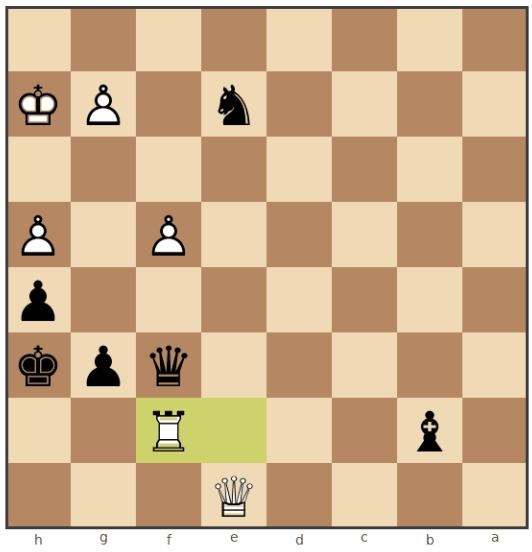
116. White to move · mate in 1



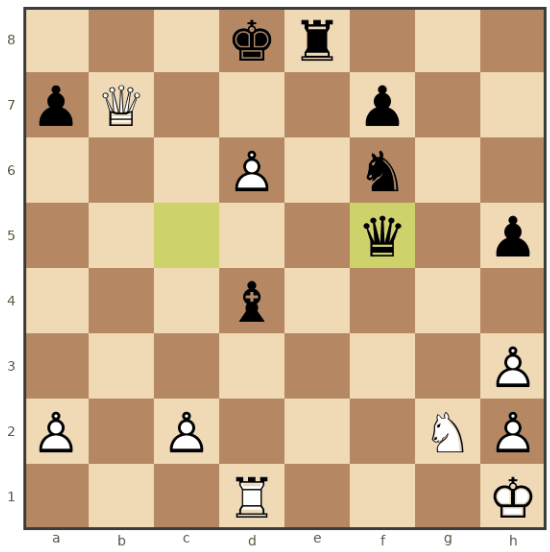
117. White to move · mate in 1



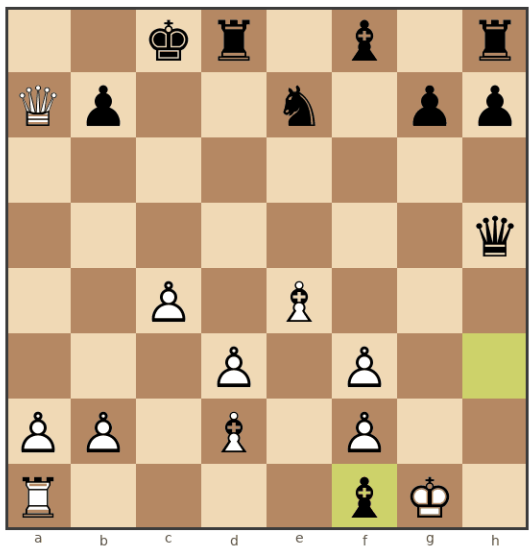
118. Black to move · mate in 1



119. White to move · mate in 1



120. White to move · mate in 1



Answers

1. 36. Rxe8# (rating 727, lichess.org/training/4K85X)
2. 27... Rxf1# (rating 789, lichess.org/training/4BCsS)
3. 26... Nc2# (rating 818, lichess.org/training/2EuP6)
4. 29. Bxe6# (rating 836, lichess.org/training/2gFzC)
5. 41. Rh3# (rating 867, lichess.org/training/5vXOR)
6. 30. Qxf7# (rating 872, lichess.org/training/279e3)
7. 7... Qc1# (rating 888, lichess.org/training/53zwk)
8. 19. Qh7# (rating 900, lichess.org/training/3abJp)
9. 36... Rf4# (rating 910, lichess.org/training/3iHyN)
10. 49... Rh5# (rating 913, lichess.org/training/5XnPN)
11. 20. Qf7# (rating 914, lichess.org/training/5Jko4)
12. 17... Ng3# (rating 916, lichess.org/training/6BIFz)
13. 48. Qh8# (rating 923, lichess.org/training/2VIbE)
14. 16. Ne4# (rating 924, lichess.org/training/5Rhly)
15. 17. Rh8# (rating 926, lichess.org/training/4s7c8)
16. 19. Qxh8# (rating 929, lichess.org/training/0FVXK)
17. 9. Bf7# (rating 930, lichess.org/training/0chef)
18. 15... Qc2# (rating 931, lichess.org/training/3kFVf)
19. 46... g5# (rating 935, lichess.org/training/4qaqq)
20. 15. Ba6# (rating 939, lichess.org/training/25GU3)
21. 32... Qf2# (rating 943, lichess.org/training/23Obm)
22. 13... Nxg3# (rating 947, lichess.org/training/28AXy)
23. 15... Qxf2# (rating 948, lichess.org/training/1biJ0)
24. 27... Qxg2# (rating 948, lichess.org/training/4Swk4)
25. 38. Rh4# (rating 949, lichess.org/training/61Efh)
26. 17... Bxf2# (rating 951, lichess.org/training/1uyAv)
27. 24. Rxf5# (rating 952, lichess.org/training/5TXPO)
28. 37. Qd7# (rating 954, lichess.org/training/4o4Oh)
29. 45... Rh1# (rating 955, lichess.org/training/4ro3d)
30. 27. Qh8# (rating 957, lichess.org/training/5dseR)
31. 48... Nxg2# (rating 960, lichess.org/training/0YjFP)
32. 53. Qh8# (rating 961, lichess.org/training/2135X)
33. 25. Rxc8# (rating 963, lichess.org/training/0u4sr)
34. 16. Qxh7# (rating 964, lichess.org/training/1YNPL)
35. 20... Qxf2# (rating 965, lichess.org/training/4UdSg)
36. 30. Qxa7# (rating 966, lichess.org/training/2AhNC)
37. 38. Qf8# (rating 967, lichess.org/training/2j2cU)
38. 12. Bf7# (rating 968, lichess.org/training/6BQFc)
39. 41. Qg4# (rating 970, lichess.org/training/1fOPe)
40. 41. Rxh6# (rating 971, lichess.org/training/3t0MP)

Answers

41. 25... Qxh2# (rating 972, lichess.org/training/0sIai)
42. 12. Qf7# (rating 973, lichess.org/training/25ZNU)
43. 33. Qg5# (rating 975, lichess.org/training/3tXPw)
44. 35. Qh8# (rating 976, lichess.org/training/4uFpj)
45. 19. Qg7# (rating 976, lichess.org/training/5r075)
46. 31. Ne7# (rating 978, lichess.org/training/0BlqB)
47. 14... Qf2# (rating 979, lichess.org/training/4LwxD)
48. 34... Qg3# (rating 980, lichess.org/training/42c41)
49. 26. Qg8# (rating 981, lichess.org/training/1FZBM)
50. 44. Qg7# (rating 981, lichess.org/training/3s7RV)
51. 10. Nd6# (rating 983, lichess.org/training/0KiSo)
52. 19. Bg7# (rating 983, lichess.org/training/2eFdm)
53. 18. Rxf7# (rating 983, lichess.org/training/3Xio6)
54. 35. Rf3# (rating 983, lichess.org/training/5clZq)
55. 20. Nf5# (rating 984, lichess.org/training/4XOU5)
56. 11... Ne2# (rating 985, lichess.org/training/2fGTZ)
57. 35. Qh8# (rating 986, lichess.org/training/4bThv)
58. 58... Qh4# (rating 988, lichess.org/training/135Kl)
59. 43... Bf2# (rating 989, lichess.org/training/4q2d8)
60. 47. Qxg5# (rating 991, lichess.org/training/2Owxa)
61. 17. Qf7# (rating 994, lichess.org/training/3jYcK)
62. 27... Nh4# (rating 997, lichess.org/training/3W5cS)
63. 26. Rxe8# (rating 998, lichess.org/training/4YNJF)
64. 20. Qg7# (rating 1002, lichess.org/training/0pT58)
65. 23... Qxg2# (rating 1005, lichess.org/training/0L6uG)
66. 20. Qf7# (rating 1006, lichess.org/training/1KXdm)
67. 39. Qxh6# (rating 1010, lichess.org/training/1wQ41)
68. 17. Qe8# (rating 1012, lichess.org/training/3J0St)
69. 11... Qxg2# (rating 1017, lichess.org/training/37ADF)
70. 21. Qxf8# (rating 1019, lichess.org/training/53Z93)
71. 24... Nf2# (rating 1024, lichess.org/training/09kPv)
72. 43... Qxa4# (rating 1024, lichess.org/training/2vs69)
73. 19. Nh6# (rating 1026, lichess.org/training/3RsBn)
74. 46... Rh2# (rating 1028, lichess.org/training/0Gjvb)
75. 11. Qg3# (rating 1029, lichess.org/training/1fUhq)
76. 10. Nf6# (rating 1031, lichess.org/training/2QNxZ)
77. 15. Qe6# (rating 1032, lichess.org/training/5tt7D)
78. 30. Qxg7# (rating 1033, lichess.org/training/4a3U8)
79. 18... Bc5# (rating 1036, lichess.org/training/4beWR)
80. 14... Qd2# (rating 1038, lichess.org/training/48nrW)

Answers

81. 17. Qf7# (rating 1042, lichess.org/training/36tLn)
82. 14... Qh2# (rating 1043, lichess.org/training/2w2Wf)
83. 19. dxe8=Q# (rating 1045, lichess.org/training/5GR54)
84. 26... Qa1# (rating 1046, lichess.org/training/62lhj)
85. 14. Ba5# (rating 1048, lichess.org/training/4ZgMv)
86. 13... hxg4# (rating 1049, lichess.org/training/39cJi)
87. 25. Rh5# (rating 1051, lichess.org/training/2zL0p)
88. 10... Qxf2# (rating 1054, lichess.org/training/2fDXQ)
89. 14... Nxg2# (rating 1055, lichess.org/training/3ma09)
90. 40... R8g3# (rating 1057, lichess.org/training/19YtT)
91. 30. Rf8# (rating 1060, lichess.org/training/1R8xx)
92. 18... Qxh4# (rating 1061, lichess.org/training/3TtYR)
93. 40... Rf2# (rating 1063, lichess.org/training/02k1g)
94. 15. Rd6# (rating 1064, lichess.org/training/04sGR)
95. 17... Rxd3# (rating 1065, lichess.org/training/3p2Eg)
96. 30... Rxe1# (rating 1066, lichess.org/training/0lYQE)
97. 49... Rb8# (rating 1068, lichess.org/training/5odCM)
98. 21... Qb5# (rating 1070, lichess.org/training/1cOer)
99. 13... Qd2# (rating 1071, lichess.org/training/17mBD)
100. 14... Rxe1# (rating 1073, lichess.org/training/0KG2p)
101. 18. Qxh7# (rating 1074, lichess.org/training/0llE5)
102. 14... Qe3# (rating 1075, lichess.org/training/2pKTF)
103. 13. Nd6# (rating 1077, lichess.org/training/02U15)
104. 18... Nxh2# (rating 1080, lichess.org/training/4c2pp)
105. 11. Bxg6# (rating 1081, lichess.org/training/58oq2)
106. 7... Qh4# (rating 1082, lichess.org/training/4zevx)
107. 16... Qh2# (rating 1083, lichess.org/training/2t6z5)
108. 56. Qa5# (rating 1083, lichess.org/training/4wKOS)
109. 55... Ra1# (rating 1084, lichess.org/training/5QDJR)
110. 44... Qh4# (rating 1086, lichess.org/training/4zzab)
111. 34. Qg7# (rating 1087, lichess.org/training/1kUMp)
112. 8... Qxf2# (rating 1089, lichess.org/training/1owPF)
113. 18. Qxb7# (rating 1092, lichess.org/training/1otXc)
114. 38... Qh1# (rating 1092, lichess.org/training/45kCK)
115. 28. Qc7# (rating 1095, lichess.org/training/4hIk4)
116. 14. Rxd8# (rating 1096, lichess.org/training/1tC6u)
117. 44. Qe8# (rating 1096, lichess.org/training/5TXqF)
118. 47... Qxh4# (rating 1098, lichess.org/training/3QSKP)
119. 29. Qc7# (rating 1099, lichess.org/training/0zTjK)
120. 21. Qxb7# (rating 1100, lichess.org/training/1nahR)